

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250276574

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

CATTOOR; Kurt et al.

WET CLUTCH COOLED PTO DISCONNECT

Abstract

A disconnect for a power take off (PTO), the disconnect comprising: an input connected to an inner rotating component of a wet clutch and an output connected to an outer rotating component of the wet clutch, the input selectively coupling to the output by compressing a clutch pack, wherein the clutch pack is compressed by way of a fluid acting on a piston and reacting on a shaft, where the fluid is delivered via an external flow.

Inventors: CATTOOR; Kurt (Koolkerke, BE), SCHACHT; Filip D. (Meulebeke, BE), VAN RAEPENBUSCH; Filip (Brugge, BE)

Applicant: Dana Belgium N.V. (Brugge, BE)

Family ID: 96881768

Appl. No.: 19/059151

Filed: February 20, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63560386 20240301

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B60K17/28 (20060101); F16D25/0638 (20060101); F16D25/12 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC B60K17/28 (20130101); F16D25/0638 (20130101); F16D25/123 (20130101);

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/560,386, entitled “WET CLUTCH COOLED PTO DISCONNECT”, and filed on Mar. 1, 2024. The entire contents of the above-listed application are hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present description relates to a disconnect between a PTO and a PTO assembly that incorporates a wet clutch.

BACKGROUND AND SUMMARY

[0003] Vehicles may have and have the ability to drive one or more work implements. Such vehicles may include off-highway work vehicles, such as straddle carriers, forklifts, tractors, and some construction vehicles. Alternatively, such vehicles may include on-highway vehicles, such as semi-trucks, utility vehicles, and some construction vehicles. A vehicle may integrate a power take-off (PTO) system to transfer mechanically energy from a vehicle to operate and affect a work implement. The PTO system and work implement may be used for a plurality of purposes, such as to power and drive a driven device, referred to herein as a PTO device. The PTO device may include a pump, a blower, an air conditioning (AC) unit, a generator, a drill, or another rotational element. Vehicles may incorporate an output to the PTO device and a PTO reduction set in the transmission. The PTO system may be driven by a mover or a plurality of movers, where the mover or movers may include internal combustions engine (ICE) and/or an electric machine, such as an electric motor or an electric motor/generator.

[0004] Pumps or other PTO devices that are energy consumers draw start or stop power from the PTO system, where torque and other rotational energy is transferred to the PTO device via the PTO system. For example, drag due to the PTO devices may cause power losses to the vehicle.

[0005] A disconnect may be used between an input to a PTO device and an output from the PTO system, such as a gearset, that may transfer power to the PTO device. When the disconnect is opened, torque may immediately stop transferring from the output to the input, reducing drag. Likewise, the disconnect may be closed after the output increases to a desired speed. However, a disconnect between the input and the output may experience large differences in rotational speed and torque during engagement. Additionally, the disconnect may experience large quantities of torque and other rotational energy during and after engagement. Therein, the disconnect may experience amounts of mechanical stress and/or strain greater than a desired first threshold of force, and/or as thermal energy build up greater than a desired second threshold of temperature, which may cause degradation. To reduce degradation, lubricant greater than or equal to a third threshold of volume may be applied to the disconnect to reduce mechanical stress and strain during closing and opening of the disconnect and remove thermal energy.

[0006] This may be at least partially achieved and issue above at least partially addressed via a disconnect for a power take off (PTO), the disconnect comprising: an input connected to an inner rotating component of a wet clutch and an output connected to an outer rotating component of the wet clutch, the input selectively coupling to the output by compressing a clutch pack, wherein the clutch pack is compressed by way of a fluid acting on a piston and reacting on a shaft, where the fluid is delivered via an external flow.

[0007] It should be understood that the summary above is provided to introduce in simplified form a selection of concepts that are further described in the detailed description. It is not meant to identify key or essential features of the claimed subject matter, the scope of which is defined uniquely by the claims that follow the detailed description. Furthermore, the claimed subject matter is not limited to implementations that solve any disadvantages noted above or in any part of this disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0008] FIG. 1 shows an example schematic of a vehicle which may include a PTO device, a PTO assembly, and a disconnect assembly of the present disclosure.

[0009] FIG. 2 shows an example schematic of a transmission system with a configuration including a plurality of PTO devices, PTO assemblies, and disconnects of the present disclosure.

[0010] FIG. 3 shows a sectional view of a disconnect assembly.

[0011] FIG. 4A shows the sectional view of the disconnect assembly with a first arrangement of valves, where the valves are shown schematically.

[0012] FIG. 4B shows the sectional view of the disconnect assembly with a second arrangement of valves, where the valves are shown schematically.

[0013] FIG. 5 shows a sectional view of a piston of the PTO device.

[0014] FIG. 6 shows a first method of advancing a piston and closing a clutch of the PTO.

[0015] FIG. 7 shows a second method of retracting a piston and closing a clutch of the PTO.

[0016] FIG. 8 shows a third method of force cooling a clutch of the PTO.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0017] The following description relates to a disconnect assembly including a lubrication system for a power take off (PTO) system that includes a PTO device and a PTO reduction set. The disconnect assembly includes an input and an output, where the input and output are rotational components that torque and rotational energy may be transmitted through. A first rotational element, such as a first shaft, may include or physically couple to the input. A second rotational element, such as a second shaft, may include or physically couple to the output. The components of disconnect assembly, including the input, the output, and components that may abut or physically couple to the input and/or output may be housed in a housing. The housing may be fluidly sealed (fluidically sealed) (e.g., be fluid tight) via a plurality of seals. The seals may include at least a first seal and a second seal, where the first seal may be positioned at opposite sides of the disconnect assembly from the second seal. The seals may include piston rings, where the first seal is or includes a first piston ring and the second seal is or includes a second piston ring. The first piston ring may fluidly seal first rotational element and/or the input with the housing. The second piston ring may fluidly seal the second rotational element and/or the output with the housing. Fluid, such as lubricant and/or actuation fluid, may be transported via fluid passages of the housing to the disconnect. Torque and rotational energy may be received via the disconnect assembly via the input. Torque may be transmitted from the disconnect assembly via the output.

[0018] The disconnect assembly includes a wet clutch, with an outer rotating component and an inner rotating component, such as a component that includes a drum and a component that includes a hub, respectively. The input may drivingly couple to the outer rotating component of the clutch. The input may physically and rigidly couple to the outer rotating component. The output may drivingly couple to the inner rotating component of the clutch. The output may physically and rigidly couple to the inner rotating component. The outer rotating component may be about, such as around, such as radially around the inner rotating component. The outer rotating component may rotate freely of the inner rotating component, and the outer rotating component may rotate and/or spin about the inner rotating component. The clutch includes a clutch pack and a piston. The clutch pack includes a plurality of friction plates and separator plates, where the friction plates may physically couple to the opposite component the separator plates physically couple to. For example, if the friction plates physically couples to the outer rotating component the separator plates physically couple to the inner rotating component. For another example if the friction plates physically couple the inner rotating component the separator plates physically couple to the outer rotating component. The friction plates and separator plates may be interleaved, such that after a

friction plate may be a separator plate, and vice versa; likewise, there may be a separator plate between a pair of friction plates and vice versa. The piston may be positioned between the outer rotational element and the clutch pack. The clutch pack may be radially between the outer rotational element and the inner rotational element. Housings and wet clutches of the present disclosure may be of any size, depending on a requested capacity. Housings may comprise any material, such as cast iron or steel. Each of the housings of the present disclosure may include two sections (e.g., pieces), with a first section and a second section, to allow variations in sizing of the input, the output, outer rotating component, and the inner rotating component.

[0019] The clutch pack may be compressed by way of a fluid acting on the piston and reacting on a rotational element and/or the outer rotating component. The piston may rotate with the first rotational element and the input. Fluid sealing between housing and first rotational element happens by means of piston rings, such as the first piston ring. Sealing provided via the piston rings may increase the life (e.g., amount of duty cycles) and decrease power losses via splashing or leaking of fluid from the disconnect assembly compared to other systems, such as a disconnect assembly that may use a trust bearing in between a piston and a pressure plate of a clutch pack. Depending on the most frequent application of the wet clutch, a normally open or normally closed wet clutch may be included by the disconnect assembly.

[0020] An external fluid line (e.g., a fluid passage) may enter the disconnect assembly. There may be a plurality of external fluid lines, where each external fluid line may deliver fluid via an external flow. The fluid to be pushed through a hollow input shaft to flow through the clutch pack from the inside to the outside, where the fluid may cool and lubricate the wet clutch. Fluid lines can be connected to a small pump and external cooler in this case. The units can work without external cooling in case of weaker duty cycles or by using spreaders in between the clutch plates and may have less capacity as when external cooling is used.

[0021] The actuation piston may have different stepped diameters to allow for some modulation when the clutch is activated to close or open. For example, a clutch pressure first acts on a small piston diameter, when the piston moves forward the bigger diameter comes free and the clutch pressure can act on the total diameter of the clutch. Steps may be with or without seals between a step of the piston and a complementary step of the housing. The valve or valves can be isolated or integrated units. Likewise, the valve or valves may be on-off valves or proportional valves, where the proportional valves allow for electronic modulation (soft closing) of the clutch. The clutch can be executed as a bolt on or as an integrated version.

[0022] FIG. 1 shows an example schematic of a vehicle which may include a PTO device, a PTO assembly, and a disconnect assembly of the present disclosure. FIG. 2 shows an example schematic of a transmission system with a configuration including a plurality of PTO devices, PTO assemblies, and disconnects of the present disclosure. FIG. 3 shows a sectional view of a disconnect assembly. FIG. 4A shows the sectional view of the disconnect assembly with a first arrangement of valves. FIG. 4B shows the sectional view of the disconnect assembly with a second arrangement of valves. The disconnect assembly of FIGS. 3-4B includes a two-piece housing (e.g., having two sections), a wet clutch including an outer rotating component having a drum and an inner rotating component having a hub, and a piston that may be advanced or retracted via changes in hydraulic pressure to open and close the clutch. The first and second arrangements of valves of FIGS. 4A-4B are shown schematically, where the first arrangement of valves are external to a housing of the disconnect assembly, and the second arrangement of valves are integrated with the housing of the disconnect assembly. FIG. 5 shows a sectional view of a piston of the PTO device, where the piston is shown separated from the other features and components of the PTO device.

[0023] FIG. 6 shows a first method of advancing a piston and closing a clutch of the PTO. FIG. 7 shows a second method of retracting a piston and closing a clutch of the PTO. FIG. 8 shows a third method of force cooling a clutch of the PTO. The first method of FIG. 6 and the third method of FIG. 8 may be performed in parallel (e.g., approximately simultaneously). Likewise, the third

method of FIG. 8 may be performed when the first method of FIG. 6 is complete and the clutch is closed. Further, the second method of FIG. 7 and the third method of FIG. 8 may be performed in parallel.

[0024] It is also to be understood that the specific assemblies and systems illustrated in the attached drawings, and described in the following specification are exemplary embodiments of the inventive concepts defined herein. For purposes of discussion, the drawings are described collectively. Thus, like elements may be commonly referred to herein with like reference numerals and may not be re-introduced.

[0025] FIGS. 1-2 shows a schematic of an example configuration with relative positioning of the various components. FIGS. 3-5 shows example configurations with approximate position. FIGS. 3-5 are shown approximately to scale; though other relative dimensions may be used. As used herein, the terms “approximately” is construed to mean plus or minus five percent of the range unless otherwise specified.

[0026] Further, FIGS. 1-5 show example configurations with relative positioning of the various components. If shown directly contacting each other, or directly coupled, then such elements may be referred to as directly contacting or directly coupled, respectively, at least in one example. Similarly, elements shown contiguous or adjacent to one another may be contiguous or adjacent to each other, respectively, at least in one example. As an example, components laying in face-sharing contact with each other may be referred to as in face-sharing contact. As another example, elements positioned apart from each other with only a space there-between and no other components may be referred to as such, in at least one example. As yet another example, elements shown above/below one another, at opposite sides to one another, or to the left/right of one another may be referred to as such, relative to one another. Further, as shown in the figures, a topmost element or point of element may be referred to as a “top” of the component and a bottommost element or point of the element may be referred to as a “bottom” of the component, in at least one example. As used herein, top/bottom, upper/lower, above/below, may be relative to a vertical axis of the figures and used to describe positioning of elements of the figures relative to one another. As such, elements shown above other elements are positioned vertically above the other elements, in one example. As yet another example, shapes of the elements depicted within the figures may be referred to as having those shapes (e.g., such as being circular, straight, planar, curved, rounded, chamfered, angled, or the like). Further, elements shown intersecting one another may be referred to as intersecting elements or intersecting one another, in at least one example. Further still, an element shown within another element or shown outside of another element may be referred as such, in one example. Moreover, the components may be described as they relate to reference axes included in the drawings.

[0027] Features described as axial may be approximately parallel with an axis referenced unless otherwise specified. Features described as counter-axial may be approximately perpendicular to the axis referenced unless otherwise specified. Features described as radial may circumferentially surround or extend outward from an axis, such as the axis referenced, or a component or feature described prior as being radial to a referenced axis, unless otherwise specified.

[0028] Features described as longitudinal may be approximately parallel with an axis that is longitudinal. A lateral axis may be normal to a longitudinal axis and a vertical axis. Features described as lateral may be approximately parallel with the lateral axis. A vertical axis may be normal to a lateral axis and a longitudinal axis. Features described as vertical may be approximately parallel with a vertical axis.

[0029] Turning now to FIG. 1, a vehicle **100** is shown comprising a powertrain **101** and a drivetrain **103**. The vehicle **100** may have a front end **132** and a rear end **134**, located on opposite sides of vehicle **100**. Objects, components, and features of the vehicle **100** referred to as being located near the front may be closest to the front end **132** compared to the rear end **134**. Objects, components, and features of the vehicle **100** referred to as being located near the rear may be closest to the rear

end **134** compared to the front end **132**. The vehicle **100** may have a longitudinal axis **130**. The powertrain **101** and drivetrain **103** may each have a length parallel with the longitudinal axis **130**. [0030] The powertrain **101** includes a prime mover **106** and a transmission **108**. For an example the prime mover **106** may be an internal combustion engine (ICE). For another example the prime mover **106** may be an electric machine, such as an electric motor or an electric motor generator. The prime mover **106** is operated to provide rotary power to the transmission **108**. The transmission **108** may be any type of transmission, such as a manual transmission, an automatic transmission, or a continuously variable transmission. Additionally, the transmission **108** may be or include a gearbox. The transmission **108** receives the rotary power produced by the prime mover **106** as an input and outputs rotary power to the drivetrain **103** in accordance with a selected gear or setting. [0031] There may be other movers that may drive and be housed by vehicle **100** besides prime mover **106**. For example, if the prime mover **106** is an ICE there may be a second mover **120** with an input to the transmission **108**, where the second mover may be an electric machine, such as an electric motor or electric motor generator. If the vehicle **100** includes the second mover **120** or other movers in addition to the prime mover **106**, the vehicle **100** may be a hybrid vehicle, wherein there are multiple torque inputs to the transmission **108**.

[0032] The prime mover **106** may be powered via energy from an energy storage device **105**. In one example, the energy storage device **105** is a battery, such as a traction battery, configured to store electrical energy. An inverter **107** may be arranged between the energy storage device **105** and the prime mover **106** and configured to adjust direct current (DC) to alternating current (AC). The inverter **107** may include a variety of components and circuitry with thermal demands that effect an efficiency of the inverter.

[0033] The vehicle **100** may be a commercial vehicle, light, medium, or heavy duty vehicle, a passenger vehicle, an off-highway vehicle, a commercial vehicle, agricultural vehicle, and/or sport utility vehicle. For an example embodiment, the vehicle **100** may be a wheeled vehicle, such as an automobile. However, additionally or alternatively, the vehicle **100** may be plane, a boat, or other vehicle system that utilizes lubricant. Additionally or alternatively, the vehicle **100** and/or one or more of its components, such as components of the powertrain **101** and/or drivetrain **103**, may be used in industrial, locomotive, military, agricultural, and/or aerospace applications. In one example, the vehicle **100** is an all-electric vehicle or a vehicle with all-electric modes of operation, such as a plug-in hybrid vehicle. As such, the prime mover **106** may be an electric machine. In one example, the prime mover **106** may be an electric motor/generator.

[0034] In some examples, such as shown in FIG. 1, the drivetrain **103** includes a first axle assembly **102** and a second axle assembly **112**. The first axle assembly **102** may be configured to drive a first set of wheels **104**, and the second axle assembly **112** may be configured to drive a second set of wheels **114**. In one example, the first axle assembly **102** is arranged near a front of the vehicle **100** and thereby comprises a front axle, and the second axle assembly **112** is arranged near a rear of the vehicle **100** and thereby comprises a rear axle. The drivetrain **103** is shown in a four-wheel drive configuration, although other configurations are possible. For example, the drivetrain **103** may include a rear-wheel drive or an all-wheel drive configuration. Further, the drivetrain **103** may include one or more tandem axle assemblies. As such, the drivetrain **103** may have other configurations without departing from the scope of this disclosure, and the configuration shown in FIG. 1 is provided for illustration, not limitation. Further, the vehicle **100** may include additional wheels that are not coupled to the drivetrain **103**.

[0035] In some configurations, such as shown in FIG. 1, the drivetrain **103** includes a transfer case **110** configured to receive rotary power output by the transmission **108**. A first driveshaft **113** is drivingly coupled to a first output **111** of the transfer case **110**, while a second driveshaft **122** is drivingly coupled to a second output **121** of the transfer case **110**. The first driveshaft **113** (e.g., a front driveshaft) transmits rotary power from the transfer case **110** to a first differential **116** of the first axle assembly **102** to drive the first set of wheels **104**, while the second driveshaft **122** (e.g., a

rear driveshaft) transmits the rotary power from the transfer case **110** to a second differential **126** of the second axle assembly **112** to drive the second set of wheels **114**. For example, the first differential **116** is drivingly coupled to a first set of axle shafts **118** coupled to the first set of wheels **104**, and the second differential **126** is drivingly coupled to a second set of axle shafts **128** coupled to the second set of wheels **114**. It may be appreciated that each of the first set of axle shafts **118** and the second set of axle shafts **128** may be positioned in a housing. The first driveshaft **113** and second driveshaft **122** may be positioned to extend in parallel with the longitudinal axis **130**. For an example of a configuration of vehicle **100**, the second driveshaft **122** may be centered about the longitudinal axis **130**.

[0036] The first differential **116** may supply a FWD in some capacity to vehicle **100**, as part of rotary power transferred via the first driveshaft **113**. Likewise, the second differential **126** may supply a RWD to the vehicle **100**, as part of the rotary power transferred via the second driveshaft **122**. The first differential **116** and the second differential **126** may supply a FWD and RWD, respectively, as part of an AWD mode for vehicle **100**.

[0037] The transmission **108** and transfer case **110** may share and be housed via a common housing assembly. The transmission **108** and the transfer case **110**, may be mounted to an axle assembly, such as the first or second axle assemblies **102**, **112**. The transmission **108** and transfer case **110** may share a common housing with a differential. Additionally or alternatively, the transmission **108** and transfer case **110** may be mounted to a differential via the common housing or specific housings. The first differential **116** may be housed in a first common housing, where the first common housing houses a transmission and transfer case, such as the transmission **108** and the transfer case **110**. Alternatively, a housing for the first differential **116** may physically couple to a second common housing, where the second common housing houses a transmission and transfer case, such as the transmission **108** and the transfer case **110**. The second differential **126** may be housed in a third common housing, where the third common housing houses a transmission and transfer case, such as the transmission **108** and the transfer case **110**. Alternatively, a housing for the second differential **126** may physically couple to a fourth common housing, where the fourth common housing houses a transmission and transfer case, such as the transmission **108** and the transfer case **110**.

[0038] The vehicle **100** may include a PTO device **144**. The PTO device **144** may be an implement, that may be driven by the vehicle **100**. For one or more examples, the PTO device **144** may be a pump, a blower, an air conditioning (AC) unit, a generator, a drill, or another rotational element/implement driven via power generated from the vehicle **100**. The PTO device **144** may be driven via power and rotational energy transferred via torque from the movers of the vehicle **100**, such as the prime mover **106** and the second mover **120**. For an example, power and rotational energy as torque may be transferred to the PTO device **144** via the transmission **108**. The transmission **108** may drivingly couple to the PTO device **144** via an input **146**, where the input **146** may be a rotational element that is an output of the transmission **108** and an input to the PTO device **144**. The input **146** may be a shaft. The transmission **108** may include a PTO assembly **142**, such as a PTO reduction set, such as a PTO gearset. The PTO assembly **142** may drivingly couple the input **146**, such as to output power and rotational energy via torque to the PTO assembly **142**. The PTO assembly **142** may increase the torque and decrease the rotational speed to the input **146** from an input of the prime mover **106** and second mover **120** or another rotational element of the transmission **108**. The PTO assembly **142** may include a plurality of reducers, such as gears.

[0039] Adjustment of the drivetrain **103** between the various modes as well as control of operations within each mode may be executed based on a vehicle control system **154**, including a controller **156**. Controller **156** may be a microcomputer, including elements such as a microprocessor unit, input/output ports, an electronic storage medium for executable programs and calibration values, e.g., a read-only memory chip, random access memory, keep alive memory, and a data bus. The storage medium can be programmed with computer readable data representing instructions

executable by a processor for performing the methods described below as well as other variants that are anticipated but not specifically listed. In one example, controller **156** may be a powertrain control module (PCM).

[0040] Controller **156** may receive various signals from sensors **158** coupled to various regions of vehicle **100**. For example, the sensors **158** may include sensors at the prime mover **106** or another mover to measure mover speed and mover temperature, a pedal position sensor to detect a depression of an operator-actuated pedal, such as an accelerator pedal or a brake pedal, a lever position sensor to detect a shifting of a lever, such as a brake lever, speed sensors at the first and second set of wheels **104**, **114**, etc. Upon receiving the signals from the various sensors **158** of FIG. **1**, controller **156** processes the received signals, and employs various actuators **160** of vehicle **100** to adjust drivetrain operations based on the received signals and instructions stored on the memory of controller **156**. For example, controller **156** may receive an indication of depression of the brake pedal, signaling a desire for decreased vehicle speed. Vehicle braking may be directly proportional to accelerator pedal position, for example, degree of depression. For another example, controller **156** may receive an indication of depression of the accelerator pedal, signaling a desire for increased vehicle speed. Vehicle acceleration may be directly proportional to accelerator pedal position, for example, degree of depression. In response, the controller **156** may command operations, such as shifting gear modes of the transmission **108**. Alternatively, the gear modes of the transmission **108** may be shifted manually, such as if the transmission **108** is a manual transmission.

[0041] In some examples, additionally or alternatively, the vehicle **100** may be a hybrid vehicle including both an engine and an electric machine each configured to supply power to one or more of the first axle assembly **102** and the second axle assembly **112**. For example, one or both of the first axle assembly **102** and the second axle assembly **112** may be driven via power originating from the engine in a first operating mode where the electric machine is not operated to provide power (e.g., an engine-only mode), via power originating from the electric machine in a second operating mode where the engine is not operated to provide power (e.g., an electric-only mode), and via power originating from both the engine and the electric machine in a third operating mode (e.g., an electric assist mode). As another example, one or both of the first axle assembly **102** and the second axle assembly **112** may be an electric axle assembly configured to be driven by an integrated electric machine.

[0042] In some embodiments, additionally or alternatively, the transmission **108** may be a first transmission, and the vehicle **100** may have a second transmission arranged on the second set of axle shafts **128**. The transmission **108** may be a gearbox. Alternatively, the transmission **108** may be an axle transmission or a trans axle transmission.

[0043] Turning to FIG. **2**, a schematic **200** of a transmission system **202** is shown. FIG. **2** shows a schematic example of a transmission system **202**. The transmission system **202** includes the transmission **108** and at least a mover **210**. The mover **210** may be the prime mover **106** or the second mover **120** of FIG. **1**. The mover **210** may be an electric machine, such as an electric motor or an electric motor/generator. The mover **210** may drivingly couple and input torque to the transmission **108**. The transmission system **202** may also include a first PTO device **204** and/or a second PTO device **206**. The first PTO device **204** and/or second PTO device **206** may drive couple and be driven via the transmission **108**.

[0044] The transmission **108** may include a plurality of reduction sets or reduction stages, such as gearsets, that are of different ratios, where a reduction set or reduction stage of a different ratio than another reduction set or another reduction stage may output a different rotational speed and torque with the same input torque. For example, the transmission **108** may include at least a reduction assembly **208**. The reduction assembly **208** may be a plurality of reduction sets, such as gearsets, of different ratios. The reduction assembly **208** may include a plurality of shafts, such as at least two shafts, or other rotational elements that may be drivingly coupled via the reduction sets the

reduction assembly **208** includes. The first PTO device **204** may drivingly couple the transmission **108** to receive power upstream of the reduction assembly **208**. The second PTO device **206** may drivingly couple the transmission **108** to receive power downstream of the reduction assembly **208**. [0045] The mover **210** may drivingly couple the transmission **108**, such as to transfer power and rotational energy to the gear assemblies of gearsets and/or other assemblies of reduction sets using non-gear reducers. The transmission **108** has at least an input **216** (e.g., a transmission input). The input **216** may be a shaft (e.g., an input shaft). The mover **210** may drivingly couple the transmission **108** via an output **214** and the input **216**. The output **214** is the output of the mover **210** (e.g., a mover output, such as an ICE output or a motor output). The mover **210** may drivingly couple the reduction assembly **208**. The mover **210** may drivingly couple the reduction assembly **208** via the input **216** and an input to the reduction assembly **208**, such as a shaft.

[0046] The transmission **108** may have a plurality of outputs including a first output **218**, a second output **220**, and a third output **222**. The first output **218**, the second output **220**, and the third output **222**, may be shafts (e.g., output shafts). The second output **220** and the third output **222** may drivingly couple to the first PTO device **204** and the second PTO device **206**, respectively. For a first example, the first output **218** may be the first output **111** or the second output **121** of FIG. 1. For an example, the first output **218** may drivingly couple to a drive shaft, such as the first driveshaft **113** or the second driveshaft **122** of FIG. 1. For this example, the first output **218** may be the first output **111** or the second output **121** of FIG. 1. Alternatively, for another example the first output **218** may be a driveshaft, such as the first driveshaft **113** or the second driveshaft **122**.

[0047] Components of the transmission system **202** that may be drivingly coupled indirectly, such as through one or more rotational elements, or are shown not touching are drivingly coupled via a plurality of drive couplings **224**. The drive couplings **224** are not a feature of a component, but rather a representation of a feature or component being drivingly coupled to another feature or component indirectly. The drive couplings **224** may be represented via a plurality of dotted lines. For example, the output **214** may be drivingly coupled to the input **216** via a drive coupling of the drive couplings **224**.

[0048] The reduction assembly **208** may receive torque and be driven via a first shaft **232**. The first shaft **232** may be an input to the reduction assembly **208**. The first shaft **232** may drivingly couple and be driven via the input **216**. The reduction assembly **208** may output torque to and drive a second shaft **234**. The second shaft **234** may be an output shaft from the reduction assembly **208**. The second shaft **234** may drivingly couple and drive the first output **218**. The first shaft **232** and second shaft **234** may be drivingly coupled via the reduction sets of the reduction assembly **208**. As the reduction assembly **208** changes between ratios of reductions sets, the reduction assembly **208** may change the speed and torque at the first output **218**. The transmission **108** may be of a multi-shaft scheme, wherein the reduction assembly **208** has a plurality of shafts that include the first shaft **232** and the second shaft **234**. The reduction assembly **208** may have shafts in addition to the first shaft **232** and the second shaft **234**.

[0049] In addition to the reduction assembly **208**, the transmission **108** may include a first reduction set **236** and/or a second reduction set **238**. The first reduction set **236** and second reduction set **238** are PTO reduction sets that may output power to a PTO. The first reduction set **236** may output power to the first PTO device **204**. The second reduction set **238** may output power to the second PTO device **206**.

[0050] The first reduction set **236** may drivingly couple the input **216** and a third shaft **244**, and the first reduction set **236** may drivingly couple the input **216** to the third shaft **244**. The input **216** may be an input to the first reduction set **236**, and input rotational energy via torque to the first reduction set **236**. The third shaft **244** may be an output for the first reduction set **236**, and may output rotational energy via torque from the first reduction set **236**. The third shaft **244** may drivingly couple to the second output **220**, such as via a first disconnect **242**. The first disconnect **242** selectively and rotationally couple the third shaft **244** to the second output **220**. The third shaft **244**

may be or may physically couple to an input to the first disconnect **242**, and the second output **220** may be or may physically couple to an output from the first disconnect **242**. Further, the third shaft **244** may rigidly couple the input to the first disconnect **242**, such as via physically coupling to the input of the first disconnect **242**. Likewise, the second output **220** may rigidly couple to an output from the first disconnect **242**, such as via physically coupling to the output from the first disconnect **242**. [0051] The second reduction set **238** may drivingly couple the second shaft **234** and a fourth shaft **248**, and the second reduction set **238** may drivingly couple the fourth shaft **248** to the second shaft **234**. The second shaft **234** may be an input to the second reduction set **238**, and input rotational energy via torque to the second reduction set **238**. The fourth shaft **248** may be an output for the second reduction set **238**, and may output rotational energy via torque from the second reduction set **238**. The fourth shaft **248** may drivingly couple to the third output **222**, such as via a second disconnect **246**. The second disconnect **246** may selectively and rotationally couple the fourth shaft **248** to the third output **222**. The fourth shaft **248** may be or may physically couple an input to the second disconnect **246**, and the third output **222** may be or may physically couple to an output from first disconnect **242**. Further, the fourth shaft **248** may rigidly couple the input to the second disconnect **246**, such as via physically coupling to the input of the second disconnect **246**. Likewise, the third output **222** may rigidly couple to an output from the second disconnect **246**, such as via physically coupling to the output from the second disconnect **246**.

[0052] The transmission **108** may include a third disconnect **252** and a fourth disconnect **254**. The third disconnect **252** may selectively and drivingly couple the input **216** to the first shaft **232**. The input **216** may be or may physically couple an input to the third disconnect **252**, and the first shaft **232** may be or may physically couple to an output from the third disconnect **252**. Further, the input **216** may rigidly couple the third disconnect **252**, such as via physically coupling to the input of the third disconnect **252**. Likewise, the first shaft **232** may rigidly couple to an output from the third disconnect **252**, such as via physically coupling to the output of the third disconnect **252**. Likewise, the fourth disconnect **254** may selectively couple and drivingly couple the second shaft **234** to a fifth shaft **256**. The second shaft **234** may be or may physically couple to an input to the fourth disconnect **254**, and the fifth shaft **256** may be or may physically couple to an output from the third disconnect **252**. Further, the second shaft **234** may rigidly couple the fourth disconnect **254**, such as via physically coupling to the input of the fourth disconnect **254**. Likewise, the fifth shaft **256** may rigidly couple to an output from the third disconnect **252**, such as via physically coupling to the output of the fourth disconnect **254**. The fifth shaft **256** may drivingly couple the first output **218**. Alternatively, the fifth shaft **256** and the first output **218** may be a common shaft or rigidly coupled to act as a unitary structure.

[0053] The first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, and the fourth disconnect **254** may have at least two modes, an open mode and a closed mode. When open in the open mode, the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, and the fourth disconnect **254** may be prevented from selectively and rotationally coupling their respective inputs and outputs. When closed in the closed mode, the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, and the fourth disconnect **254** may selectively and rotationally couple their respective inputs and outputs.

[0054] The first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, the fourth disconnect **254**, and/or other disconnects of the present disclosure may be normally closed or normally open during the operations of a vehicle, such as the vehicle **100**, that houses and may be driven via the transmission **108**. For example, for a vehicle where the first PTO device **204** is desired or requested to operate, and the vehicle remains in place and not driven under power during normal operations, the first disconnect **242** may be normally closed while the third disconnect **252** may be normally open. Likewise, for another example, for another vehicle where the first PTO device **204** is not desired or requested to operate and the vehicle drives under power during normal operations, the first disconnect **242** may be normally open while the third disconnect **252** may be

normally closed. For another example, there may be another vehicle where the second PTO device **206** is desired or requested to operate and the vehicle may remain in place and not driven under power during normal operations, the second disconnect **246** may be normally closed while the fourth disconnect **254** may be normally open. Likewise, for another example, there may be another vehicle where the second PTO device **206** is not desired or requested to operate and the vehicle drives under power during normal operation, the second disconnect **246** may be normally open while the fourth disconnect **254** may be normally closed.

[0055] Likewise, the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, the fourth disconnect **254**, and/or other disconnects of the present disclosure may be normally closed or normally open during the PTO operations of a PTO. The PTO may include a PTO device and the PTO reduction set, such as the first PTO device **204** and first reduction set **236** and/or the second PTO device **206** and second reduction set **238**. For example, during a PTO operation of a first PTO that includes the first PTO device **204** and the first reduction set **236**, the first disconnect **242** may be normally closed and the third disconnect **252** may be normally open. For another example, during a PTO operation of a second PTO that includes the second PTO device **206** and the second reduction set **238**, the second disconnect **246** may be normally closed and the fourth disconnect **254** may be normally open.

[0056] The first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, the fourth disconnect **254**, and/or other disconnects of the present disclosure may be closed hydraulically. A pressure adjustment device **282** may be fluidly couple and supply pressure to close the clutches of the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, the fourth disconnect **254**, and/or other disconnects of the present disclosure. The pressure adjustment device **282** may be fluidly coupled to the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, the fourth disconnect **254**, and/or other disconnects via a plurality of fluid lines **284**. More specifically at least a pair of valves may place each of the clutches of the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, the fourth disconnect **254**, and/or other disconnects of the present disclosure in fluid communication with the one or more of the fluid lines **284** and the pressure adjustment device **282**. Pressure and fluid flow may be transported through fluid lines **284**.

[0057] For an example, the pressure adjustment device **282** may be a pump. For another example, the pressure adjustment device **282** may be a pressure intensifier. For a further example, the pressure adjustment device **282** may be a pressure booster. For an additional example, the pressure adjustment device **282** may be another pressure adjustment device or a system of smaller pressure adjustment devices therein that may include two or more of a pump, a pressure intensifier, and/or a pressure booster.

[0058] The first reduction set **236** may be a gearset. As a gearset, the first reduction set **236** may have at least two gears, including a first gear **262** and a second gear **264**. The first gear **262** may be an input gear for the first reduction set **236**. The first gear **262** may rotationally couple to the input **216**. Alternatively, the first gear **262** may rotationally couple to a shaft or another rotational element that may couple to the input **216** and is upstream with respect to power from the reduction assembly **208**. The second gear **264** may be an output gear for the first reduction set. The second gear **264** may rotationally couple to the third shaft **244**. The first gear **262** may drive the second gear **264**. Additionally, for an example, the first reduction set **236** may have a third gear **266**. The third gear **266** may be an idler gear in mesh between the first gear **262** and the second gear **264**. As an idler gear, the third gear **266** may rotate in mesh with the first gear **262** and the second gear **264**, such that the first gear **262** and the second gear **264** rotate in the same direction. For this example, when driven, the third shaft **244** may rotate in the same direction as the input **216** via the first reduction set **236**.

[0059] It is to be appreciated that for another example, the first reduction set **236** may not have an idler gear and may be of a configuration with the first gear **262** and the second gear **264** in mesh, or

be of another configuration with an even amount of gears. When in mesh without an idler gear between, the first gear **262** and the second gear **264** may rotate in opposite directions. Likewise, for a further example, for a configuration of the first reduction set **236** with an even amount of gears between the first gear **262** and the second gear **264**, the first gear **262** and the second gear **264** may rotate in opposite directions. For these example, when driven, the third shaft **244** may rotate in a second direction opposite to a first direction the input **216** rotates.

[0060] The second reduction set **238** may be a gearset. As a gearset, the second reduction set **238** may have at least two gears including a fourth gear **272** and a fifth gear **274**. The fourth gear **272** may be an input gear for the second reduction set **238**. The fourth gear **272** may rotationally couple to the second shaft **234**. The fifth gear **274** may be an output gear for the first reduction set. The fifth gear **274** may rotationally couple to the fourth shaft **248**. The fourth gear **272** may drive the fifth gear **274**. Additionally, for an example, the second reduction set **238** may have a sixth gear **276**. The sixth gear **276** may be an idler gear in mesh between the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274**. As an idler gear, the sixth gear **276** may rotate in mesh with the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274**, such that the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274** rotate in the same direction. For this example, when driven, the fourth shaft **248** may rotate in the same direction as the second shaft **234** via the second reduction set **238**.

[0061] It is to be appreciated that for another example, the second reduction set **238** may not have an idler gear and may be of a configuration with the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274** in mesh, or be of another configuration with an even amount of gears. When in mesh without an idler gear between, the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274** may rotate in opposite directions. Likewise, for a further example, for a configuration of the second reduction set **238** with an even amount of gears between the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274**, the fourth gear **272** and the fifth gear **274** may rotate in opposite directions. For these examples, when driven, the fourth shaft **248** may rotate in a second direction opposite to a first direction the second shaft **234** rotates.

[0062] A set of reference axes **301** are provided for comparison between views shown in FIG. 3. The reference axes **301** indicate a y-axis, an x-axis, and a z-axis. In one example, the z-axis may be parallel with a direction of gravity, and the x-y plane may be parallel with a horizontal plane that a disconnect assembly **302** of FIG. 2 may rest upon. When referencing direction, positive may refer to in the direction of the arrow of the y-axis, x-axis, and z-axis and negative may refer to in the opposite direction of the arrow of the y-axis, x-axis, and z-axis. A circle may represent an axis of the reference axes **301** that is normal to a view. A circle may represent an axis of the reference axes **301** that is normal to a view. A filled circle may represent an arrow and axis facing toward, or positive to, a view. An unfilled circle may represent an arrow and an axis facing away, or negative to, a view.

[0063] Turning to FIG. 3, it shows a view **300** of a disconnect assembly **302**. Disconnects that are of the configuration of disconnect assembly **302** may be used as the first disconnect **242**, the second disconnect **246**, the third disconnect **252**, or the fourth disconnect **254** of FIG. 2. The disconnect assembly **302** may have a first side **304** and a second side **306**, where the first side **304** is opposite the second side **306**. The disconnect assembly **302** may be centered around a central axis, such as an axis **307** or another axis parallel therewith, such that components of the disconnect assembly may be positioned radially around the central axis. The axis **307** may be a longitudinal axis for the disconnect assembly **302**. The axis **307** or another example of the central axis of the disconnect assembly **302** may be a rotational axis for the disconnect assembly **302**. The disconnect assembly **302** may include a housing **308**, a clutch **310**, an input **314**, and an output **316**.

[0064] The housing **308** may have two sections: a first section **309** and a second section **311**. The first section **309** and the second section **311** are separate pieces of the housing **308**. The first section **309** may include and be closest to the first side **304**. The second section **311** may include and be closest to the second side **306**. The housing **308** may have a first cavity **312**. The first cavity **312** may house the clutch **310**. A second cavity **321** may be created between the input **314** and the

output **316**.

[0065] The clutch **310** is a wet clutch, where components of the clutch **310**, such as a clutch pack and clutch plates, may be immersed in fluid that is a lubricant and coolant during operations. The clutch **310** includes a first rotating component and a second rotating component. The first rotating component may be an outer rotating component **318** and the second rotating component may be an inner rotating component **320**, where the outer rotating component **318** includes or physically couples to first features that are positioned about and rotate around second features of or that are physically coupled to the inner rotating component **320**. The outer rotating component **318** may include or physically couple to a drum **322**. The first features may include the drum **322**. The outer rotating component **318** may include an extension **326**. The drum **322** may be outward, with respect to the axis **307**, from the extension **326**. The drum **322** may be radially outward from the extension **326**. The drum **322** may curve about, such as radially around, the extension **326**. The inner rotating component **320** may include or physically couple to a hub **324**. The second features may include the hub **324**. The drum **322** may be positioned around the hub **324**, such as radially around the hub **324**. The hub **324** may be positioned around the extension **326**, such as radially around the extension **326**. The input **314** may drivingly couple and physically couple to the outer rotating component **318**. The output **316** may drivingly couple to the inner rotating component **320**. The input **314** and the outer rotating component **318** may be nearest to the first side **304**. The output **316** and the inner rotating component **320** may be nearest to the second side **306**. The housing **308** may be positioned about the input **314** and the output **316**. The first section **309** may be positioned about, such as around, the outer rotating component **318**. The outer rotating component **318** may be positioned about, such as around, such as radially around, the input **314**. Likewise, the second section **311** may be positioned about, such as around, the inner rotating component **320**. The inner rotating component **320** may be positioned about, such as around, such as radially around, the output **316**.

[0066] The outer rotating component **318** includes a third cavity **328**. The drum **322** may curve around a third cavity **328**. Likewise, the inner rotating component **320** may include a fourth cavity **330**. The hub **324** may curve around at least a section of the fourth cavity **330**. The drum **322** may be positioned about the hub **324**, such that portions of the hub **324** may be housed in the third cavity **328**.

[0067] The housing **308** and the first cavity **312** may be fluidly sealed (e.g., be fluid tight) via a plurality of seals, such that fluid may not exit the housing **308** to an exterior of the first cavity **312**. The seals may include at least a first seal **332** and a second seal **334**. The first seal **332** may be at the first side **304** and the second seal **334** may be at the second side **306**. The first seal **332** may be between and create a fluid tight seal between the input **314** and the housing **308**. More specifically, the first seal **332** may be between and create a fluid tight seal between the outer rotating component **318** and the first section **309**. The second seal **334** may be between and create a fluid tight seal between the output **316** and the housing **308**. More specifically, the second seal **334** may be between and create a fluid tight seal between the inner rotating component **320** and the second section **311**. The seals may include fastening components, where the first seal **332** is complementary to a first fastening component **336**, and the second seal is complementary to a second fastening component **338**. The seals may include piston rings, where the first seal **332** is or is complementary to a first piston ring, and the second seal **334** is or is complementary to a second piston ring. The first piston ring may fluidly seal the outer rotating component **318** and/or the input **314** with the housing **308**. The second piston ring may fluidly seal the inner rotating component **320** and/or the output **316** with the housing **308**.

[0068] A plurality of bearings may support the input **314** and the outer rotating component **318**, such as a plurality of bearings of a first bearing assembly **342** and a second bearing assembly **344**. The first bearing assembly **342** and the second bearing assembly **344** may each include a plurality of bearings; such as ball bearings. The first and second bearing assemblies **342**, **344** may be

positioned around the outer rotating component **318**. The first and second bearing assemblies **342**, **344** may allow the input **314** and the outer rotating component **318** to rotate freely of the housing **308**.

[0069] A plurality of bearings may support the output **316** and the inner rotating component **320**, such as a plurality of bearings of a third bearing assembly **346** and a fourth bearing assembly **348**. The third bearing assembly **346** and the fourth bearing assembly **348** may each include a plurality of bearings; such as ball bearings. The third and fourth bearing assemblies **346**, **348** may be positioned around the inner rotating component **320**. The third and fourth bearing assemblies **346**, **348** may allow the output **316** and the inner rotating component **320** to rotate freely of the housing **308**.

[0070] The clutch **310** may further include the drum **322**, the hub **324**, a piston **358**, a clutch pack **356**, and at least a spring **362**. The drum **322** may curve about the piston **358** and the clutch pack **356**, such as radially about the piston **358** and clutch pack **356**. The spring **362** may be housed and mechanically supported by a carrier component **360**. The hub **324** may curve about the carrier component **360**, such as radially about the carrier component **360**. More specifically, the hub **324** may curve radially around the carrier component **360**. The piston **358**, the carrier component **360**, and the spring **362** may be positioned about the extension **326**, such as radially about the extension **326**. More specifically, the piston **358**, the carrier component **360**, and the spring **362** may be positioned radially around the extension **326**.

[0071] The outer rotating component **318** may have a first surface **352** that is normal to the axis **307**. The inner rotating component **320** may have a second surface **354** normal to the axis **307**. The second surface **354** may be or may be part of a counter hole extending radially from a section **355** of the fourth cavity **330**. The section **355** has a smaller diameter than the inner diameter of the hub **324** that curves around the spring **362**.

[0072] The piston **358** may be sandwiched between the first surface **352** and the clutch pack **356**. Likewise, the piston **358** may be sandwiched between the first surface **352** and the carrier component **360**, where the piston **358** may be sandwiched between the first surface **352** and the spring **362**. Additionally or alternatively, there may be a plurality of springs housed via the fourth cavity **330** and the carrier component **360**, including one or more of the spring **362**.

[0073] The clutch pack **356** may include a plurality of separator plates **366** and a plurality of friction plates **368**. The clutch pack **356** may also include an end plate **364**. The hub **324** may include the friction plates **368** physically coupled thereto. The drum **322** may include the separator plates **366** physically coupled thereto. The end plate **364** may physically couple to the drum **322**. A force in a longitudinal direction may close the clutch pack **356** via pressing the friction plates **368** into surface sharing contact with the separator plates **366**. For example, force from the piston **358** abutting and pressing against the clutch pack **356** above a threshold of force may close the clutch pack **356**. The force from the piston **358** may be longitudinal and in a direction toward the second side **306**.

[0074] An actuation chamber **372** may be formed between the first surface **352** and the piston **358**. A counter-pressure chamber **374** may be formed between the piston **358** and the inner rotating component **320**. A spring **362** may be housed in counter-pressure chamber **374**. The actuation chamber **372** and the counter-pressure chamber **374** may each house fluid. The actuation chamber **372** may be a chamber that receives and is pressurized by work fluid to change the state of the clutch. Increasing fluid pressure to the actuation chamber **372** may advance the clutch in the direction of the second side **306**. Upon advancing a first threshold of distance, the piston **358** may press upon and apply force to the clutch pack **356**. The application of force from the pressing of the piston **358** to the clutch pack **356** may compress the clutch pack **356**. Compression of the clutch pack **356** may press the friction plates **368** to abut and make surface contact with the separator plates **366**, causing the clutch **310** to engage in a closed state.

[0075] The spring **362** in the counter-pressure chamber **374** may resist the advancement of the

piston **358**, where the spring **362** may apply a resistive force via a spring force opposite to the direction of engagement for the piston **358**. For example, the spring **362** may apply a resistive force a direction toward the first side **304**. The spring **362** and other springs of the counter-pressure chamber **374** may be one or more return springs that may return the piston to a position in the direction of the first side **304**, such as if the pressure of the actuation chamber **372** is decreased. Likewise, fluid, such as lubricant and/or coolant, housed via the counter-pressure chamber **374** may apply a resistive force via pressure opposite to the direction of engagement for the piston **358**. [0076] Decreasing the pressure to the actuation chamber **372** may advance the clutch in the direction of the first side **304**, as the resistive forces of the spring **362** and fluid in the counter-pressure chamber **374** become greater than the force of fluid in the actuation chamber **372** places on the piston **358**.

[0077] Advancing the piston **358** in the direction of the first side **304** may reduce or remove force placed by the piston **358** to the clutch pack. The reduction or removal of force from the piston **358** to the clutch pack **356**, may expand the clutch pack **356**. Expansion of the clutch pack **356** may allow friction plates **368** to expand from the separator plates **366**, causing the clutch **310** to disengage and enter an open state (e.g., opening the clutch **310**).

[0078] When the disconnect assembly **302** is closed, the clutch **310** is in a closed state. Likewise, when the disconnect assembly **302** is open, the clutch **310** is in an open state. When the disconnect assembly **302** is normally closed, the clutch **310** is normally closed. When the disconnect assembly **302** is normally open, the clutch **310** is normally open.

[0079] A first distance between the piston **358** and the first surface **352** may be modulated via pressure in the actuation chamber **372**, such that the first distance may increase at greater pressure or decrease at lower pressure from a first state of pressure of the actuation chamber **372**. A second distance between the piston **358** and the clutch pack **356** may be modulated, such that the piston **358** may press and compress the clutch pack **356** to smaller sizes or release and decompress the clutch pack **356** to a larger size. The second distance may be modulated via pressure of the actuation chamber **372**, such that the second distance may decrease at a greater pressure or decrease at a lower pressure from the first state of pressure of the actuation chamber **372**. The force the piston **358** may place on the clutch pack **356** may be modulated, such as via the pressure in the actuation chamber **372**. The force from the piston **358** to the clutch pack **356** may be increased with a greater pressure and may be decreased with a lower pressure from the first state of pressure of the actuation chamber **372**.

[0080] The piston **358** may have a fifth cavity **370** and a sixth cavity **371**. The fifth cavity **370** may be above the sixth cavity **371**. The sixth cavity **371** may be of size such that the hub **324** fit to the sixth cavity **371**. As the piston **358** advances in a direction toward the second side **306**, the hub **324** may fit to the sixth cavity **371**. The fourth cavity **330** may be placed in fluid communication with the clutch pack **356** via the fifth cavity **370** and the sixth cavity **371**. Fluid, including lubricant, may flow between the clutch pack **356** and the fourth cavity **330** via the fifth cavity **370** and/or sixth cavity **371**. Both the fifth cavity **370** and the sixth cavity **371** may reduce the amount of material for and mass of the piston **358**. The sixth cavity **371** may allow the piston **358** to move toward the second side **306**, around the hub **324**, and into contact with the clutch pack **356**, such that the hub **324** is prevented from contacting and blocking the piston **358** before contacting with the clutch pack **356**.

[0081] Fluid, such as actuation fluid, may flow via a first flow path **376** to the actuation chamber **372** via a first flow path **376**. Fluid, such as lubricant, such as oil, may flow via a second flow path **378** to the counter-pressure chamber **374**. Actuation fluid housed by and supplied to the actuation chamber **372** via the first flow path **376** may be a lubricant. Likewise, the actuation fluid supplied via the first flow path **376** and the lubricant supplied via the second flow path **378** may be the same type of fluid, such as oil. Alternatively, the actuation fluid supplied via the first flow path **376** and the lubricant supplied via the second flow path **378** may be different types of fluid. The first flow

path **376** and second flow path **378** may deliver fluid via an external fluid flow, where fluid may be delivered external to the disconnect assembly **302**. The second flow path **378** may be cooled externally of the disconnect assembly **302**.

[0082] The fluid on the first flow path **376** may travel through a plurality of fluid passages and volumes of the housing **308** and the outer rotating component **318** to the actuation chamber **372**. Likewise, fluid on the second flow path **378** may travel through a plurality of fluid passages and volumes of the housing **308** and the outer rotating component **318** to the counter-pressure chamber **374** and to the fourth cavity **330**. The housing **308** may have a first passage **382** and a fourth passage **390**, where the first section **309** specifically may include the first passage **382** and fourth passage **390**. The outer rotating component **318** may include a second passage **384**, a third passage **388**, a fifth passage **392**, and a sixth passage **394**. The first passage **382**, the second passage **384**, the third passage **388**, the fourth passage **390**, the fifth passage **392**, and the sixth passage **394** may be fluid passages, such as fluid lines. The first passage **382**, the second passage **384**, the third passage **388**, the fourth passage **390**, the fifth passage **392**, and the sixth passage **394** may extend in a radial direction with respect to the axis **307**. There may be a plurality of the first passages **382**, the second passages **384**, the third passages **388**, the fourth passages **390**, the fifth passages **392**, and the sixth passages **394**.

[0083] The second passage **384** may be fluidly coupled to the third passage **388**, such as via an eighth cavity **386** of the outer rotating component **318**. The second passage **384** may have a bend **385**. The fifth passage **392** may fluidly couple to the sixth passage **394** via a seventh cavity **375**. The seventh cavity **375** may be radially between the outer rotating component **318** and the input **314**. Fluid housed via the fourth cavity **330** and the counter-pressure chamber **374** may be in fluid communication with the clutch pack **356**, such as via the fifth cavity **370** and sixth cavity **371**. A third seal **377** may be positioned between, such as radially between, one or more first surfaces of the outer rotating component **318** and one or more second surfaces of the output **316**, creating a fluid seal therebetween. Alternatively, the seal **377** may be positioned between the outer rotating component **318** and another rotating element, such as one or more surfaces of the input **314**. The seal **377** may be arranged to fluidically seal the seventh cavity **375** from the counter-pressure chamber **374**.

[0084] Further, the drum assembly **322** may include a plurality of seventh passages **387**. Further, the hub **324** may include a plurality of eighth passages **389**. The seventh passages **387** may be holes and may extend radially outward and through the drum assembly **322**. Likewise, the eighth passages **389** may be holes and may extend radially outward and through the hub **324**. Further the seventh passages **387** and the eighth passages **389** may be bores. The seventh passages **387** may place a first volumetric space radially between the drum assembly **322** and the hub **324** in fluid communication (e.g., fluidically couple) with other volumetric spaces of the first cavity **312** around the drum assembly **322**. Further, the eighth passages **389** may place the fourth cavity **330** and the counter-pressure chamber **374** in fluidic communication (e.g., fluidically couple) with other volumetric spaces between the drum assembly **322** and the hub **324**. The clutch pack **356** may therein be placed in fluidic communication with volumetric spaces between the housing **308** and the drum assembly **322** via the seventh passages **387**. Further, the clutch pack **356** may be placed in fluidic communication and be fluidically coupled to the counter-pressure chamber **374** via the eighth passages **389**.

[0085] Fluid may also exit the counter-pressure chamber **374** and the fourth cavity **330** via the second flow path **378**, via a plurality of fluid passages. Fluid may exit the counter-pressure chamber **374** and the fourth cavity **330** via a ninth passage **396**. The ninth passage **396** may be included by the output **316**. The ninth passage **396** may be in fluid communication with the second cavity **321**.

[0086] Fluid may flow to and pressurize the actuation chamber **372** via the first flow path **376**. For example, fluid following and/or pressurizing the first flow path **376** may flow through housing **308**

via the first passage **382**. Fluid following and/or pressurizing the first flow path **376** may enter the second passage **384** from the first passage **382**. Fluid following and/or pressurizing the first flow path **376** may enter the eighth cavity **386** via the second passage **384**. Fluid following and/or pressurizing the first flow path **376** may enter the third passage **388** from the eighth cavity **386**. Fluid following and/or pressurizing the first flow path **376** may enter the actuation chamber **372** via the third passage **388**. Fluid may also flow from and depressurize the actuation chamber **372** via the first flow path **376**. For another example, the removal and/or depressurization of fluid housed via the actuation chamber **372** may be facilitate by fluid following the first flow path **376** in reverse order through fluid passages and other volumes for flowing fluid to and pressurizing the actuation chamber **372**. Additionally, fluid may be forced out of and depressurize the actuation chamber **372** along the first flow path **376**, via increasing fluid flow and pressure to the counter-pressure chamber **374** via the second flow path **378**.

[0087] Fluid following the second flow path **378** may flow through housing **308** via the fourth passage **390**. Fluid following the second flow path **378** may enter the fifth passage **392** from the fourth passage **390**. Fluid following the second flow path **378** may enter the seventh cavity **375** via the fifth passage **392**. Fluid following the second flow path **378** may enter the sixth passage **394** via the seventh cavity **375**. Fluid following the second flow path **378** may enter the counter-pressure chamber **374** and the fourth cavity **330** via the sixth passage **394**. Fluid flowing via second flow path **378** may force cool the clutch **310** from the counter-pressure chamber **374**. For example, the fluid from the second flow path **378** may force cool the clutch pack **356** by traveling via volumes between the piston **358** and the hub **324**, such as via the fifth cavity **370** and sixth cavity **371**. Further, for this or another example, the fluid from the second flow path **378** may force cool the clutch **310** and clutch pack **356** via flowing through the eighth passages **389**. The fluid force cooling the clutch pack **356** may exit and flow outward from the clutch pack **356** via the seventh passages **387**. The fluid forced outward via the seventh passages **387** along the second flow path **378** may enter spaces of the first cavity **312** around the clutch **310**. Fluid following the second flow path **378** may be removed from the first cavity **312** via entering passages and volumes of rotational elements of the disconnect assembly **302** and/or the ninth passage **396**. Further, fluid following the second flow path **378** may be removed from the disconnect assembly **302** via the ninth passage **396**.

[0088] Fluid may be directed to enter and exit the disconnect assembly **302** and fluid passages and volumes of the disconnect assembly via a valve or a plurality of valves. There may be a valve specific to each flow path, with a first valve for the first flow path **376** and a second valve for the second flow path **378**. The opening, partial opening, partial closing, and closing of valves may start, increase, decrease, and/or stop, respectively, the volumetric flow of fluid along the first flow path **376** and the second flow path **378**.

[0089] The valves of and for the disconnect assembly **302** may be isolated or integrated units. For an example, the disconnect assembly **302** may comprise valves that are integrated units. A valve complementary to the disconnect assembly **302**, such as a valve to supply fluid to the first flow path **376** or the second flow path **378**, may be an integrated valve. Likewise, a plurality of valves complementary to the disconnect assembly **302** may be integrated valves. Additionally or alternatively, a valve complementary to the disconnect assembly **302**, such as a valve to supply fluid to the first flow path **376** or the second flow path **378**, may be an isolated valve from the disconnect assembly **302**. Likewise, a plurality of valves complementary to the disconnect assembly **302** may be isolated valves from the disconnect assembly **302**.

[0090] The valves of the disconnect assembly **302** may be on-off valves and/or proportional valves, where the proportional valves may allow electronic modulation (soft closing) of the clutch. For an example, one or more of the valves that are on-off valves, may be solenoids or have solenoid components, (e.g., be on-off solenoid valves or have on-off solenoid components). For this or another example, all of the valves that are on-off valves may be solenoids or have solenoid

components. Likewise, for these or another example, one or more of the valves that are proportional valves, may be solenoids or have solenoid components, (e.g., be proportional solenoids or have proportional solenoid components). For these or another example, all of the valves that are proportional valves may be proportional solenoids or have proportional solenoid components.

[0091] It is to be appreciated, that the view **300** shows a portion of the disconnect assembly **302**, and therein there may be other portions and features of the disconnect assembly. For example, the components and their features of the disconnect assembly **302** may be mirrored opposite the axis **307** from the view **300**, such as below the axis **307** with respect to the z-axis of the reference axes **301**.

[0092] Turning to FIG. **4A**, it shows the view **400** of a first example of the disconnect assembly **302**. The view **400** is the view **300** of the disconnect assembly **302**, but including a first set of a plurality of valves that may be in fluidic communication with the actuation chamber **372** and the counter-pressure chamber **374**. The first example of the assembly **302**, the valves are isolated valves that are external to the housing **308**. For example, the valves include a first valve **422** and a second valve **424** that are each an isolated valve external to, but fluidically coupled to, the assembly **302** and the housing **308**. The first valve **422** and the second valve **424** are shown schematically.

[0093] The first valve **422** may fluidly couple to the first passage **382**. The first valve **422** may open to increase or decrease pressure and/or fluid flow to volumes in fluidic communication along the first flow path **376**. For example, fluid volumes that receive or remove fluid along the first flow path **376** may be pressurized and/or receive fluid from or depressurized and/or deliver fluid to the first valve **422**. For an example, the first valve **422** may be an on-off valve. For another example, the first valve **422** may be a proportional valve, allowing for soft closing of the clutch **310**. The first valve **422** may be in fluid communication with a pressure adjustment device, such as the pressure adjustment device **282** of FIG. **2**. The pressure adjustment device may supply fluid and hydraulic pressure to the first valve **422**.

[0094] The second valve **424** may fluidly couple to the fourth passage **390**. The second valve **424** may open or close to increase or decrease, respectively, pressure and/or fluid flow to volumes fluidically coupled along the second flow path **378**. For example, fluid volumes that receive or remove fluid along the second flow path **378** may be pressurized and/or receive fluid from or depressurized and/or deliver fluid to the second valve **424**. For an example, the second valve **424** may be an on-off valve. For another example, the second valve **424** may be a proportional valve, allowing for soft closing of the clutch **310**. The second valve **424** may be in fluid communication with a pressure adjustment device, such as the pressure adjustment device **282**. The pressure adjustment device may supply fluid and hydraulic pressure to the second valve **424**.

[0095] Turning to FIG. **4B**, it shows the view **450** of a second example of the disconnect assembly **302**. The view **450** is the view **300** of the disconnect assembly **302**, but including a first set of a plurality of valves that may be in fluidic communication with the actuation chamber **372** and the counter-pressure chamber **374**. The second example of the assembly **302**, shows the valves are integrated valves that are internal to the housing **308**. More specifically, the valves may be housed by and/or rigidly coupled to the housing **308**. For example, the valves include a third valve **432** and a fourth valve **434** that are each an integrated valve housed via the housing **308** and included as part of the assembly **302**. The third valve **432** and the fourth valve **434** are each fluidically coupled to at least a passage the assembly **302** and the housing **308**. The third valve **432** and the fourth valve **434** are shown schematically.

[0096] The third valve **432** may fluidly couple to one or more passages of the first flow path **376**. For example, the third valve **432** may fluidly couple to the first passage **382** and the second passage **384**. The third valve **432** may open to increase or decrease pressure and/or fluid flow to volumes in fluidic communication along the first flow path **376**. For example, fluid volumes that receive or

remove fluid along the first flow path **376** may be pressurized and/or receive fluid from or depressurized and/or deliver fluid to the third valve **432**. For an example, the third valve **432** may be an on-off valve. For another example, the third valve **432** may be a proportional valve, allowing for soft closing of the clutch **310**. The third valve **432** may be in fluid communication with a pressure adjustment device, such as the pressure adjustment device **282** of FIG. 2. The pressure adjustment device may supply fluid and hydraulic pressure to the third valve **432**.

[0097] The fourth valve **434** may fluidically couple to the fourth passage **390**. The fourth valve **434** may open or close to increase or decrease, respectively, pressure and/or fluid flow to volumes in fluidic communication along the first flow path **376**. For example, fluid volumes that receive or remove fluid. For example, fluid volumes that receive or remove fluid along the second flow path **378** may be pressurized and/or receive fluid from or depressurized and/or deliver fluid to the fourth valve **434**. For an example, the fourth valve **434** may be an on-off valve. For another example, the fourth valve **434** may be a proportional valve, allowing for soft closing of the clutch **310**. The fourth valve **434** may be in fluid communication with a pressure adjustment device, such as the pressure adjustment device **282**. The pressure adjustment device may supply fluid and hydraulic pressure to the fourth valve **434**.

[0098] Turning to FIG. 5, it shows a view **500** of at least a portion of the piston **358** and the features therein. View **500** is a sectional view of the piston **358**. Additionally, view **500** shows the piston **358** separated from other components and features of the assembly **302** of FIG. 3 with exception to one or more seals rigidly coupled and directly coupled thereto. The view **500** also shows an axis **508**. The portion of the piston **358** may be arranged around and above the axis **508**. The axis **508** may be parallel with the axis **307** of FIG. 3.

[0099] The piston **358** has a first side **504** and a second side **506**, where the first side **504** is opposite the second side **506**. The first side **504** may be an actuation side of the piston **358**, wherein the first side **504** may face and shape an actuation chamber, such as the actuation chamber **372** of FIGS. 3-4B. Likewise, the second side **506** may be a counter-pressure side, wherein the second side **506** may face and shape a counter-pressure chamber, such as the counter-pressure chamber **374** of FIGS. 3-4B.

[0100] The first side **504** of the piston **358** may include a first cavity **510**, a second cavity **512**, and a hole **514**, where a material **516** of the piston **358** and the surfaces thereof curve around the first cavity **510**, the second cavity **512**, and the hole **514**. The hole **514** may be a through hole. The first cavity **510**, the second cavity **512** and the hole **514** are volumetrically connected and continuous. The second cavity **512** and/or the hole **514** may be concentric to the piston **358** and centered, such as radially around a rotational axis, such as the axis **307**. The first cavity **510** may be around and outward from the second cavity **512**. The first cavity **510** and the second cavity **512** may be undercuts extending into the material **516**.

[0101] Likewise, the first side **504** of the piston **358** may have a first step **522** and a second step **524**. The second step **524** is outward from the first step **522**, such as radially outward with respect to the axis **307**. The piston **358** may have a valley **520** that curves outward toward the second step **524** and that surfaces of the first and/or second steps **522**, **524** are shaped around. Likewise, a piston **358** may have a valley **526** that curves outward toward the first step **522** and that surfaces of the first step **522** are shaped around. The valleys **526**, **520** may be referred to herein as the first valley **526** and the second valley **520**, respectively. The second step **524** may curve around, such as radially around, the first cavity **510**. Further, the first cavity **510** may be an undercut of the second step **524**. The first step **522** may curve around, such as radially around, the second cavity **512**. Further, the second cavity **512** may be an undercut of the first step **522**.

[0102] One or more surfaces of the first step **522** that connect to with one or more surfaces of the second step **524** may define the shape of the second valley **520**. Said in another way, one or more surfaces of the first step **522** shaping the second valley **520** are contiguous with one or more surfaces of the second step **524**. For example, a surface **525** part of the first step **522** may have a

first portion normal to the axis **508** and a second portion that curves with and defines the shape of the second valley **520**. The second portion of surface **525** may become increasingly curved and radial with respect to a rotational axis of a piston **358** with the shape of the second valley **520** closer toward the second step **524**.

[0103] The first valley **526** curves toward the first step **522** from a surface **518**. Surface **518** connects with one or more surfaces of the first step **522** via the first valley **526**, such that surface **518** is contiguous with one or more surfaces of the second step **524**. Likewise, surface **518** may define the shape of the first valley **526**. Said in another way, the surface **518** shaping the first valley **526** is contiguous with one or more surfaces of the second step **524**. For example, the surface **518** may have a first portion normal to the axis **508** and a second portion that curves with and defines the shape of the first valley **526**. The second portion of surface **518** may become increasingly curved and radial with respect to a rotational axis of a piston **358** with the shape of the first valley **526** closer toward the first step **522**.

[0104] The piston **358** may also include a first groove **528** and a second groove **532**. The first groove **528** may be included by outward most portion of the piston **358**, such as a radially outward portion of the piston **358**. Therein, the first groove **528** may face and be open to components outward of the piston **358**, such as radially outward. More specifically, the first groove may be incorporated into a support of the piston **358**. The second groove **532** may be included by an inward most portion of the piston **358**, such as a radially inward portion of the piston. Therein, the second groove **532** may face and be open to components inward of the piston **358**, such as radially inward.

[0105] A first seal **530** may be fit to the first groove **528**. More specifically, the first groove **528** may house the first seal **530** such that the first seal **530** is retained to or rigidly coupled to the piston **358** via the first groove **528**. A second seal **534** may be fit to the second groove **532**. More specifically, the second groove **532** may house the second seal **534**, such that the second seal **534** is retained to or rigidly coupled to the piston **358** via the second groove **532**. A first surface **536** may be contiguous with surfaces of the that are around and form the shape of the second groove **532**. Likewise, a second surface **538** may be contiguous and connected to surface **518** and surface **536**. A third surface **540** may extend toward and around the second groove **532**. The third surface **540** may extend from the second side **506** in direction toward the first side **504**. The first surface **536**, the second surface **538**, and the third surface **540** may curve radially around the rotational axis of the piston **358**.

[0106] The first seal **530** first seal may contact, abut, and fluidly seal against a first component placed around and rigidly coupled to the piston **358**, such as the outer rotating component **318** and the drum **322** thereof shown via FIGS. 3-4B. Further the first seal **530** may rigidly couple with to the first component placed around the piston **358**. Likewise, the second seal **534** may contact, abut, and fluidly seal against a second component the piston **358** is placed around and rigidly coupled to, such as the outer rotating component **318** and the extension **326** thereof shown via FIGS. 3-4B. Further the second seal **534** may rigidly couple with to the second component. Rotating the piston **358**, and, more specifically, the first seal **530** and the second seal **534** with the first component and the second component may prevent or reduce degradation to the first seal **530** and the second seal **534** from sheer forces, frictional forces, and centripetal force, compared to if the piston **358** was rotating at a different speed from the first component and the second component. For example, rotating the piston **358** with the input **314**, the outer rotating component **318**, and, more specifically, the outer drum **322** and the extension **326** at approximately the same speed, may reduce or prevent degradation to the outer rotating component **318**, the drum **322**, and the piston **358**, such as degradation from sheering forces, frictional forces, and centripetal force. Likewise, the rotating the piston **358** with the input with the input **314**, the outer rotating component **318**, and, more specifically, the outer drum **322** and the extension **326** at approximately the same speed, may prevent or reduce degradation to the first seal **530** and the second seal **534**, such as degradation

from sheering forces, frictional forces, and centripetal force.

[0107] The second side **506** may include a plurality of lands or other structures, referred to herein as pressers (e.g., presses), that may face, extend toward, contact, and press against one or more components of a clutch pack or one or more components housed via a counter-pressure chamber. For example, the pressers of the second side **506** may face, extend toward, contact, and press against components of the clutch pack **356** and the spring **362** of FIGS. 3-4B. The second side **506** may also include one or more supports that may be lands or other structures that one or more components of the disconnect assembly may rest upon and/or be supported by.

[0108] The pressers of the second side **506** may include a first presser **542**, a second presser **544**, and a third presser **546** that may be lands extending in a direction parallel with the axis **307**. The first presser **542** may be arranged outward, such as radially outward, from the second presser **544** and the third presser **546** relative to the rotational axis of the piston **358**. The second presser **544** may be arranged outward, such as radially outward, from the third presser **546** relative to the rotational axis of the piston **358**. The fifth cavity **370** may be sandwiched between the first presser **542** and the second presser **544**. Likewise, the sixth cavity **371** may be sandwiched between the second presser **544** and the third presser **546**.

[0109] The supports of the piston **358** may include a support **548** that is radially inward from the third presser **546**. The support **548** may be a cylindrical structure or a tubular structure, such as a collar, that the springs of the assembly **302**, such as the spring **362** may rest upon.

[0110] The first presser **542** may have a fourth surface **552**, the second presser **544** may have a fifth surface **554**, and the third presser **546** may have a sixth surface **556** that may be a normal to the axis **508** and therein the rotational axis of the piston **358**. The fourth surface **552** and the fifth surface **554** may be contact surfaces that may each contact, abut, and press against at least a plate of the clutch pack **356** of FIG. 3, such as a separator plate or friction plate of the separator plates **366** and the friction plates **368**, respectively, of FIG. 3. Likewise, the sixth surface **556** may be a contact surface that may contact, abut, and press against one or more springs, such as the spring **362** of FIGS. 3-4B.

[0111] The second side **506** may also include a seventh surface **558** that curves around the fifth cavity **370** and an eighth surface **560** that curves around the sixth cavity **371**. The surfaces **558**, **560** are curved and may each have a circular radius.

[0112] The piston **358** may include a plurality of diameters, such as a first diameter **562**, a second diameter **564**, and a third diameter **566**. The first diameter **562** may be an outer diameter and an outer width of the of the piston **358**. Further, the first diameter **562** may be an outer diameter for the second step **524**. The second diameter **564** may be an inner diameter of the second step **524** and the diameter of the first cavity **510**. The third diameter **566** may be an inner diameter of the first step **522** and the diameter of the second cavity **512**. The second diameter **564** is greater in distance than the third diameter **566**.

[0113] The seventh surface **558** may have a curvature of a first radius **572**. The eighth surface **560** may have a curvature of a second radius **574**. The second radius **574** may be larger than the first radius **572**.

[0114] Turning to FIG. 6, it shows a flow chart of a method **600** to close one or more of plurality of PTO disconnects of an assembly (e.g., a disconnect assembly) of the present disclosure, such as assembly **302** of FIGS. 3-4B, such that an input and an output thereof may selectively couple. The disconnect assembly includes a clutch assembly with an outer rotating component rigidly coupled to or a part of the input, an inner rotating component rigidly coupled to or a part of the output, and a clutch pack, such as the outer rotating component **318**, the inner rotating component **320**, and the clutch pack **356**, respectively of FIGS. 3-4B. The outer rotating component may be an input to the clutch and may be rigidly coupled or a part of the input to the assembly, such as the input **314** of FIGS. 3-4B. The inner component may be an output from the clutch and may be rigidly coupled with or a part of the output of the assembly, such as the output **316** of FIGS. 3-4B. The piston may

rigidly couple to and rotate with the outer rotating component and a shaft that may drive the outer rotating component, such as the input **314**.

[0115] The piston includes seals, such as the first seal and second seal, or other features sealing the piston with the outer rotating component and an input coupled thereto, such that the piston fluidically seals against the input and other components rigidly coupled thereto. The sealing via the seals and/or other features of the piston create the counter-pressure chamber and the actuation chamber.

[0116] Method **600** begins at **602**, opening a first valve to flow a first fluid to a counter-pressure chamber of the disconnect assembly. Opening the first valve, results in changing a pressure through and at the exit of the first valve, referred to herein as a first pressure. **602** also include flowing the first fluid from the first valve to the counter-pressure chamber via a first passage of a housing around the disconnect and at least a second passage of the shaft and/or the outer rotating component. Flowing fluid to the counter-pressure chamber may increase the pressure of the counter-pressure chamber and the first fluid housed within. The pressure of the counter-pressure chamber may be referred to herein as a second pressure. The second pressure is above a threshold such that a clutch pack of the clutch is cooled and lubricated via the first fluid traveling from the counter-pressure chamber through the clutch pack. Further **602** may include flowing the first fluid through a cavity around the shaft sandwiched between the shaft and the outer rotating component, such as the seventh cavity **375** of FIGS. **3-4B**.

[0117] The first fluid flowed via the first valve may be a lubricant and a coolant, such as oil. Further the first fluid flowed may be a work-fluid. The first valve may be the second valve **424** of FIG. **4A** or the fourth valve **434** of FIG. **4B**. The counter-pressure chamber may be the counter-pressure chamber **374** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The first passage of the housing may be the fourth passage **390** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The second passage of the shaft may be the fifth passage **392** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The cavity may be the seventh cavity **375** of FIGS. **3-4B**. If the counter-pressure chamber is empty of first fluid or partially filled with first fluid, the counter-pressure chamber is filled with the first fluid such that the first fluid fills the approximate volume of the counter-pressure chamber. For an example, the approximate volume of the counter-pressure chamber is at a maximum volume or a threshold volume such that the piston is prevented from contacting the clutch pack.

[0118] The second pressure and the spring force of the springs of the counter-pressure chamber may place a plurality of forces on the piston in a direction parallel with the rotational axis referred to herein as first forces.

[0119] Method **600** continues to **604**, opening a second valve to flow a second fluid to an actuation chamber. Opening the second valve, results in changing another pressure through and at the exit of the second valve. The pressure at and through the second valve may be referred to herein as a third pressure. **604** also includes flowing the second fluid from the first valve to the actuation chamber via a third passage of the housing around the disconnect and at least a fourth passage of the outer component. Flowing the second fluid to the actuation chamber increases pressure of the actuation chamber and the second fluid housed within. The pressure of the actuation chamber may be referred to herein as fourth pressure. **604** includes pressing one or more surfaces of the piston via forces from the fourth pressure. More specifically, **604** includes pressing one or more surfaces of a first step in fluid communication with actuation chamber with a force(s) having a vector parallel with the axis of rotation. The fourth pressure produces at least a second force having a vector parallel with the axis of rotation. **604** also includes flowing the second fluid to a cavity of the outer component in fluid communication with the actuation chamber.

[0120] The second fluid may be a work-fluid, such as oil, to the actuation chamber of the disconnect assembly. For a first example the first fluid of **602** and the second fluid of may be the same fluid sharing an approximately the same composition. For a second example, the first fluid and the second fluid of may be different fluids of differing compositions.

[0121] The first forces of the counter-pressure chamber and the second forces of the actuation

chamber may have vectors opposite to one another. The first forces and second forces may combine to form a net force referred to herein as a third force. The third force may be positive, e.g., greater than a threshold of 0, when the magnitude of the second forces is greater than an opposing magnitude of the first forces. Likewise, the third force may be negatives, e.g., less than a threshold of 0, when the magnitude of the first forces is greater than the opposing magnitude of the second forces.

[0122] The second valve may be the first valve **422** of FIG. 4A or the third valve **432** of FIG. 4B. The actuation chamber may be the actuation chamber **372** of FIGS. 3-4B. The third passage may be the first passage **382**, the fourth passage may be the second passage **384**, and the cavity may be the eighth cavity **386**. The first step may be the first step **522** of FIG. 5. If the actuation chamber is empty of second fluid or partially filled with second fluid, the actuation chamber is filled with the second fluid such that the second fluid fills the approximate volume of the actuation chamber. The volume of the actuation chamber may be the sum of a first volume of a hole, such as the hole **514** of FIG. 5, and a second volume of chambers within at least a step, such as the first cavity **510** and the second cavity **512**, of a piston minus the volume of a component the piston is positioned around, such as the extension **326** of FIG. 3. For an example, the approximate volume of the counter-pressure chamber is at a minimum volume or below another threshold volume such that the piston is prevented from contacting the clutch pack.

[0123] Method **600** may continue to **605**, rotating a shaft and the piston simultaneously. More specifically, spinning the shaft, the outer rotating component, and the piston around a rotational axis of the disconnect assembly. Rotation of the shaft and the piston may be driven via a mover, such as an electric machine or an ICE. The shaft may be the input or may rigidly couple to the input. **605** is optional step of method **600** and may be skipped, such as if the shaft does not receive rotational energy or is locked from rotating. The shaft may be the input **314** or another shaft rigidly coupled to the input **314** of FIGS. 3-4B. Fluid sealing between the housing and the outer rotating component, and the outer rotating component and the piston, happens by means of piston rings, such as the first piston ring. Sealing provided via the piston rings may increase the life (e.g., amount of duty cycles) and decrease power losses via splashing or leaking of fluid from the disconnect assembly compared to other systems, such as a disconnect assemblies that may use a trust bearing in between a piston and a pressure plate of a clutch pack.

[0124] Method **600** continues to **606**, increasing the third pressure to the second valve and the pressure of the fluid passages and other fluid lines, and the actuation chamber in fluid communication therein. For example, pressure may be increased to the second valve via increasing the power output and pressure on the pressure side of a pump in fluid communication with the second valve. For this or another example, the pressure may be increased to the second valve via diverting flow of the second fluid from and/or placing the pressure side of another pressure adjustment device, such as a fluid intensifier or pressure booster, in fluid communication with the valve.

[0125] Method **600** continues to **608**, increasing the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber via flowing and/or pressurizing first fluid from the second valve. Method **600** and **608** continue to **610**, increasing the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber above a first threshold of pressure. The fourth pressure may be increased above the first threshold, by increasing the third pressure to the second valve until equal to or above a second threshold of pressure. For an example, the second threshold of pressure may be approximately greater than or equal to the first threshold of pressure. For another example, the second threshold of pressure may be approximately less than or equal to the first threshold of pressure. Above the first threshold of pressure, the second forces placed on the piston from the actuation chamber greater than or equal to a threshold of force, such as to be greater than a sum of the third forces from the pressure of the counter-pressure chamber and spring force of one or more springs.

[0126] After **610**, method **600** continues to **614**, compressing the springs of the counter-pressure

chamber and translating the piston. At **614**, the actuation chamber begins increasing in volume and the counter-pressure chamber begins decreasing in volume. At the second threshold of pressure the second forces are greater than a non-zero threshold of force, referred to herein as a first threshold of force. At or above the first threshold of force, the second forces are greater than the first forces of the counter-pressure chamber, causing the springs and volume of the counter-pressure chamber to compress. The compression of the springs allows translation of the piston toward the clutch pack. The springs and counter-pressure chamber may continue to compress and the piston may continue to advance toward the clutch pack, until the compression of the springs and counter-pressure chamber increases the first forces and expansion of the actuation chamber decreases the second forces to be equal, causing the third force (e.g., net force) to equal zero. Further, upon contact between piston and the clutch pack, the resistive force of the clutch pack may add to the first forces upon contact between the piston and clutch pack, such that the first forces are equal in magnitude to the sum of the second forces and the resistive forces from the clutch pack. And therein, the pressing of the clutch pack in further steps of method **600** may stop the compression of the springs.

[0127] Method **600** continues to **616**, translating the piston a first threshold of distance, placing at least a second step of the piston in fluid communication with the actuation chamber, and allowing one or more surfaces of the second step to be pressed upon via the forces from the pressure of the piston chamber. At the first threshold of distance a gap is formed large enough between a surface of the outer component that shapes the actuation chamber and one or more surfaces of the second step, allowing the second fluid to enter the gap. As the second fluid fills the gap, the gap becomes volumetrically continuous with and a part of the actuation chamber. Further the area of surfaces of the piston receiving force from pressure of the actuation chamber increases, decreasing the pressure of the actuation chamber and spreading the force therefrom over a larger area. Said in another way, before **616** the fourth pressure of actuation chamber pressure (e.g., clutch pressure) is first acting on a small piston diameter of a first area, and during and after **616** the fourth pressure is acting on a large piston diameter (e.g., relative to the small piston diameter). The large piston diameter and diameter of the outer diameter of second step may be approximately the total diameter of the clutch. The second step may be the second step **524** of FIG. 5. The increase in area decreases the pressure of the actuation chamber, and therein decreases the second forces on the piston from the counter-pressure chamber. Further the expansion of the formation of the gap and decrease in the second forces may decrease the speed the piston translates and the springs compress.

[0128] Method **600** continues to **618**, advancing the piston a second threshold of distance into contact with a feature of the clutch pack. For example, advancing the piston to contact a plate of the clutch pack, such as a pressure plate or, alternatively, a separator plate or a friction plate. Contact may be made between the piston and the clutch pack via one or more lands extending from the piston toward the counter-pressure chamber, such as the first presser **542** and the second presser **544** of FIG. 3. At **620**, method **600** continues by pressing the clutch pack, pressing the plates therein together, compressing and closing the clutch pack, and selectively coupling the outer rotating component to the inner rotating component. More specifically, at **620** closing the clutch pack selectively couples a drum of the outer rotating component to a drum of the inner rotating component. Upon closing the clutch pack, the pressed plates abut and resist further translation of the piston. Said in another way, the resistive force of the clutch pack adds an additional force to the first forces, and causes the first forces to become equal in magnitude to the second forces, and the third force to equal zero.

[0129] After **620**, method **600** ends.

[0130] Turning to FIG. 7, it shows a flow chart of a method **700** to open one or more of a plurality of PTO disconnects of an assembly (e.g., a disconnect assembly) of the present disclosure, such as the assembly **302** of FIGS. 3-4B, such that an input and an output thereof may decouple from a state where selectively and rigidly coupled. The disconnect assembly includes a clutch assembly, such as clutch **310**, with an outer rotating component, an inner rotating component, and a clutch

pack, such as the outer rotating component **318**, the inner rotating component **320**, and the clutch pack **356**, respectively, of FIGS. **3-4B**. The outer rotating component may be an input to the clutch and may be rigidly coupled to another input to the disconnect assembly, such as the input **314** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The inner component may be an output and may be rigidly coupled with an output to the disconnect assembly, such as the output **316** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The piston may be rigidly coupled and rotate with the outer rotating component and a shaft that may drive the outer rotating component, such as the input **314**.

[0131] Method **700** begins at **702**, determining that the clutch of the disconnect assembly is in a closed state, selectively and rigidly coupling the outer rotating component and the inner rotating component and, by extension, selectively coupling the input and the output. At **702**, the piston of the disconnect assembly is contacting the clutch pack, and pressing a plurality of plates of the clutch pack, such as the separator plates **366** and friction plates **368** of FIGS. **3-4B**, together. The fourth pressure of the actuation chamber is equal to or above a first threshold of pressure and the piston is pressing with the second forces from the actuation chamber equal to or greater than a first threshold of force, selectively coupling the plates of the clutch pack via friction and therein selectively coupling the outer rotating component and the inner rotating component. Further, the second forces are equal to the sum of the first forces of the counter-pressure chamber and the resistive forces from the clutch pack, preventing further translation of the piston toward and against the clutch pack.

[0132] Method **700** continues to **602** introduced in method **600** of FIG. **6**, opening the first valve to flow a first fluid that to a counter-pressure chamber of the disconnect assembly. Opening the first valve, results in changing a pressure through and at the exit of the first valve to the first pressure. The first valve may be the second valve **424** of FIG. **4A** or the fourth valve **434** of FIG. **4B**. The counter-pressure chamber may be the counter-pressure chamber **374** of FIGS. **3-4B**.

[0133] **602** may also include flowing the first fluid from the first valve to the counter-pressure chamber via the first passage of the housing around the disconnect and at least the second passage of the shaft and/or the outer rotating component. First fluid flowed via the first valve may be a work fluid, a lubricant, and a coolant, such as oil. The first passage of the housing may be the fourth passage **390** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The second passage of the shaft may be the fifth passage **392** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The cavity may be the seventh cavity **375** of FIGS. **3-4B**.

[0134] Method **700** continues to **604** introduced in method **600** of FIG. **6**, opening the second valve to flow a second fluid to the actuation chamber. Opening the second valve, results in changing another pressure through and at the exit of the second valve to approximately a second pressure. **604** also includes flowing the second fluid from the first valve to the actuation chamber via the third passage of the housing around the disconnect and the fourth passage of the outer component. It is to be appreciated that the pressure of the actuation chamber may be at a fourth pressure before opening the second valve. The second valve may be the first valve **422** of FIG. **4A** or the third valve **432** of FIG. **4B**. The actuation chamber may be the actuation chamber **372** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The third passage may be the first passage **382**, the fourth passage may be the second passage **384**, and the cavity may be the eighth cavity **386**.

[0135] **604** includes pressing one or more surfaces of a first step in fluid communication with actuation chamber with the second forces, where the second forces remain parallel with the axis of rotation and may remain equal to or greater than the first threshold of force. **604** also includes flowing the second fluid to a cavity of the outer component in fluid communication with the actuation chamber. The second fluid may be a work-fluid, such as oil, to an actuation chamber of the disconnect assembly.

[0136] For a first example the first fluid and the second fluid of may be the same fluid sharing an approximately the same composition. For a second example, the first fluid and the second fluid of may be different fluids of differing compositions. At **604** for method **700**, the fourth pressure is at or above the first threshold of pressure.

[0137] It is to be appreciated, the steps of opening the first valve at **602** and/or the second valve at **604** may occur before the start of method **700**. If the first valve is already opened, **602** may be skipped. If the second valve is already opened, **604** may be skipped.

[0138] Method **700** may continue to **605** introduced in method **600** of FIG. 6, rotating a shaft and the piston simultaneously. Rotation of the shaft and the piston may be driven via a mover, such as an electric machine or an ICE. The shaft may be the input or may rigidly couple to the input. **605** is optional step of method **600** and may be skipped, such as if the shaft does not receive rotational energy or is locked from rotating. The shaft may be the input **314** or another shaft rigidly coupled to the input **314** of FIGS. 3-4B.

[0139] Method **700** continues to **706**, decreasing the magnitude of the second forces pressing against the clutch and, more specifically, the clutch pack of the disconnect assembly via the piston. **706** of method **700** includes a plurality of sub-steps including at least **708**. At **708**, method **700** includes decreasing the pressure the actuation chamber.

[0140] **708** of method **700** includes a plurality of sub-steps. **708** begins at **710** by decreasing the third pressure at the second valve, and therein the pressure of the fluid passages, other fluid lines, and the actuation chamber in fluid communication therein. For example, the third pressure may be decreased to the second valve via decreasing the power output and pressure on the pressure side of a pump in fluid communication with the second valve. Additionally or alternatively, the third pressure may be decreased via placing the second valve in fluid communication with the suction side of the pump, the suction side of another pump, and/or the suction side of another pressure adjustment device, such as a pressure intensifier or a pressure booster. Additionally or alternatively, the third pressure may be decreased via placing the second valve in fluid communication with a fluid body at a lower pressure than the second valve and the actuation chamber, such as a reservoir or a sump. Placing the second valve in fluid communication with the suction side of a pressure adjustment device or a fluid body having a lower pressure may flow fluid out of the fluid channels, fluid lines, and volumes of the disconnect assembly in fluid communication with second valve, decreasing the pressures therein. The second valve may be placed in fluid communication with the suction side of a pressure adjustment device or a fluid body via fluid coupling via another valve or a plurality of other valves. Further, the second valve may be removed from fluid communication with the pumping side of a pressure adjustment device via closing an additional valve or a plurality of additional valves fluidically coupled thereto. Method **700** therein continues to **712**, decreasing the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber via the second valve. Said in another way, **712** includes depressurizing the actuation chamber. The fourth pressure of the second fluid decreases in pressure, and second fluid may flow out of the counter-pressure chamber via the second valve.

[0141] **712** may include decreasing the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber below the first threshold. The fourth pressure may decrease below the first threshold after decreasing the third pressure through and exiting the second valve at **710**, until the third pressure is less than a second threshold of pressure. For an example, the second threshold of pressure may be approximately greater than or equal to the first threshold of pressure. For another example, the second threshold of pressure may be approximately less than or equal to the first threshold of pressure. Below the first threshold of pressure, the second forces placed on the piston from the actuation chamber decreases to less than the first threshold of force, such as to be less than a sum of third forces from the sum of first forces of the counter-pressure chamber and the resistive forces of the clutch pack. Said in another way, the third force (e.g., net force) to decreases to a non-zero threshold, where below the first threshold of pressure the third force may be negative.

[0142] Method **700** continues to **722**, actuating the clutch, via expanding and decompressing the clutch pack therein after decreasing the second forces from the piston and actuation chamber below the first threshold. **722** includes opening the clutch pack from a closed state, via decreasing the first force to the clutch, via decreasing the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber and increasing the second pressure of the counter-pressure chamber. The decrease in the first force to the clutch below

another threshold of force, such as zero, allows for expansion of the clutch pack expanding the plates apart therein.

[0143] Method **700** continues to **724** expanding the spring and actuating the piston via translation toward the actuation chamber. More specifically, the piston begins translating in a direction parallel with the axis of rotation toward the actuation chamber, and more specifically toward one or more surface of the outer rotating component around the actuation chamber. Actuation is accomplished by the third forces of the springs and the second pressure of the counter-pressure chamber becoming greater than the second forces from the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber. At **724**, the actuation chamber begins decreasing in volume and compressing, and the counter-pressure chamber begins increasing in volume and decompressing. It is to be appreciated, that **722** and **724** may occur approximately simultaneously, or **724** may occur before **722**.

[0144] Method **700** continues to **726**, opening the clutch via translating the piston a first threshold of distance toward the actuation chamber from a starting position where the clutch is closed. More specifically, at **726**, the friction plates and separator plate finish expanding out of contact. Further, at **726**, the full decompressing and opening of the clutch pack includes decoupling the outer rotating component to the inner rotating component. More specifically, at **726** opening of the clutch pack decouples a drum of the outer rotating component to a hub of the inner rotating component. At **726** the piston may still be contacting the clutch pack of the clutch via a plate. The plate may be a pressure plate or, alternatively, a friction plate or separator plate.

[0145] Method **700** continues to **738**, translating the piston out of contact with and away from the clutch and the clutch pack therein. The piston continues to be actuated via the second forces in from the counter-pressure chamber, including forces from the springs and the second pressure toward one or more walls of the outer rotating component around the actuation chamber.

[0146] Method **700** may continue **740**, retracting the piston via translation to a second threshold of distance, scaling at least a step of the piston against at least a surface. The step of the piston may be an outer step of the of the piston, such as the second step **524** of FIG. 5. The surface may be a surface of the outer rotating component, such as the first surface **352** of FIGS. 3-4B. At the second threshold of distance a gap formed between the surface and one or more surfaces of the step is eliminated or decreased below a threshold of volume, pushing the second fluid out of the gap. Further, the area of surfaces of the piston receiving second forces from pressure of the actuation chamber decreases, increasing the pressure of the actuation chamber and shrinking the area. The second forces may increase in magnitude, decreasing a first speed the piston retracts and a second speed the spring expands. Said in another way, before **740** the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber is first acting on a first piston diameter of a first area. After **616** the fourth pressure is acting on a smaller second piston diameter of a smaller second area (e.g., where small is relative to the first piston diameter and first area). The second force may increase after closing the gap. The first piston diameter and diameter of the outer diameter of second step may be approximately the total diameter of the clutch. The second step may be the second step **524** of FIG. 5.

[0147] It is to be appreciated, that **740** is optional step of method **700** and may be skipped, such as if the piston lacks a step structure or has steps that remain in fluid communication with fluid passages fluidly coupled to or in fluid communication with the second valve.

[0148] Method **700** may continue to **742**, where the piston may abut one or more surfaces of the outer rotating component and be prevented from translating further theretoward. The sum of a resistive force of one or more surfaces of the outer rotating component and the second forces increases to a non-zero threshold of force equal to the first forces.

[0149] It is to be appreciated, that **742** is optional step of method **700** and may be skipped, such as if the second forces increase to a non-zero threshold of force equal to the first forces before contact is made between the piston and rotating component.

[0150] After **738**, after **740**, or after **742**, method **700** ends.

[0151] Therein the inventors have developed methods, such as method **600** and method **700**, that

provide support for actuating a clutch of a disconnect of a PTO comprising: sealing a piston of the disconnect with a shaft, such that the piston fluidically seals against the shaft and other components rigidly coupled thereto and creates a counter-pressure chamber and an actuation chamber on opposite sides thereof, rotating the piston with the shaft around an axis of rotation, increasing a first pressure of a first work fluid at a first valve of the disconnect in fluid communication with the counter-pressure chamber, flowing the first work fluid from the first valve to the counter-pressure chamber via a first passage of a housing around the disconnect and at least a second passage of the shaft, pressurizing the counter-pressure chamber to a second pressure of a first threshold preventing self-closing of the piston above a second threshold of rotational speed, flowing the first work fluid to a clutch pack of the clutch from the counter-pressure chamber via features of the piston, cooling the clutch pack via the first work fluid, changing a third pressure of a second work fluid at a second valve of the disconnect in fluid communication with the actuation chamber for the piston and at least a surface of the piston, pressurizing the actuation chamber to a fourth pressure of a third threshold, and, actuating the piston in a direction parallel with the axis of rotation via a net force from the second pressure of the counter-pressure chamber and the fourth pressure of the actuation chamber.

[0152] Further, in a first example the inventors have developed a method, such as method **600**, comprising: increasing the fourth pressure to the third threshold, pressing on at least a first surface of a first step of a first diameter of the piston facing the actuation chamber via the fourth pressure, compressing a spring of the counter-pressure chamber, translating the piston toward the clutch pack, translating the piston a first distance of at least fourth threshold such that at least a second surface of a second step of a second diameter of the piston is placed in fluid communication with the actuation chamber, pressing on at least the second surface via force from the fourth pressure, translating the piston a second distance of at least a fifth threshold into surface sharing contact with the clutch pack, pressing plates of the clutch pack, and closing the clutch pack selectively coupling an input of the disconnect to an output of the disconnect, where the second diameter of the second step is greater than the first diameter of the first step.

[0153] Further in a second example the inventors have developed a method, such as method **700**, optionally including the first example comprising: decreasing the fourth pressure to the third threshold, decreasing force placed on the piston from the actuation chamber and removing force from the piston to the clutch pack, expanding a spring of the counter-pressure chamber, translating the piston away from the clutch pack, opening the clutch pack and decoupling an input of the disconnect from an output of the disconnect, translating the piston a first distance of at least a fourth threshold out of contact with the clutch pack, and translating the piston a second distance of at least a fifth threshold such that at least a surface of a step of a diameter of the piston seals against a surface of the shaft and exits fluid communication with the actuation chamber.

[0154] Turning to FIG. **8**, it shows a flow chart of a method **800** for cooling a clutch and the clutch pack for a disconnect of a PTO, such as the clutch **310** and the clutch pack therein of disconnect assembly **302** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The clutch is force cooled via a fluid. The fluid is a coolant for the clutch pack. Further the fluid is a lubricant for the plates of the clutch pack. Additionally, the fluid is work fluid for a counter-pressure chamber of the disconnect assembly, where the fluid that may react against forces that may translate a piston facing the counter-pressure chamber with surfaces contacting the fluid therein. The fluid may be oil. The clutch includes an outer rotating component, an inner rotating component, and a clutch pack, such as the outer rotating component **318**, the inner rotating component **320**, and the clutch pack **356**, respectively, of FIGS. **3-4B**. The outer rotating component may be an input to the clutch and may be rigidly coupled to another input to the disconnect assembly, such as the input **314** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The inner rotating component may be an output from the clutch and may be rigidly coupled with an output to the disconnect assembly, such as the output **316** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The piston may be rigidly coupled and rotate with the outer rotating component and a shaft that may drive the outer rotating component, such as the input **314**.

[0155] Method **800** begins at **802** by opening a valve in fluid communication with the counter-pressure chamber. The valve may be opened to be in fluid communication with a reservoir, a line, or another volume of the fluid. The valve is in fluid communication with the counter-pressure chamber of the assembly via at least a first fluid passage of a housing for the disconnect assembly and the clutch, and via at least second fluid passage of a shaft. The shaft may be the input to the disconnect assembly via which rotational energy, such as via torque, may rotate the disconnect and components of the clutch. The counter-pressure chamber is positioned around the shaft and around features of the outer rotating component and the inner rotating component. Further the counter-pressure chamber is sandwiched between a piston, such as the piston **358**, and the inner rotating component. The valve may be the first valve described via the method **700** of FIG. **7** and method **800** of FIG. **8**. Further, the valve may be either the second valve **424** of FIG. **4A** or the fourth valve **434** of FIG. **4B**. The first passage may be the fourth passage **390** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The second passage may be the fifth passage **392** of FIGS. **3-4B**. The housing may be the housing **308** of FIGS. **3-4A**.

[0156] Optionally, method **800** may continue to **804**, increasing pressure of the fluid to the valve, such as if a first pressure to the valve is below a first threshold of pressure. Above the first threshold of pressure the flow rate of the fluid through the valve, (e.g., the volumetric flow rate) is great enough to continuously fill the counter-pressure chamber to a desired fluid level, allowing for transportation of the fluid to the clutch pack. Said in another way the first threshold of pressure may be a minimum pressure to force cool the clutch via the fluid of the counter-pressure chamber. It is to be appreciated that method **800** is optional and may be skipped if the pressure of the valve is at or above the first threshold of pressure.

[0157] Method **800** continues to **806**, flowing the fluid via the at least the first fluid passage through the housing for the clutch and toward the shaft.

[0158] Upon the fluid exiting the first fluid passage, method **800** continues to **808**, flowing the fluid into the second fluid passage from the first fluid passage, and flowing the fluid via at least the second fluid passage to the counter-pressure. Fluid may exit the second fluid passage via flowing to a volume around a rotating element of the disconnect assembly, such the seventh chamber of FIGS. **3-4B**. For an example, the rotating element may be the shaft and input to the disconnect assembly. For another example, the rotating element may be another shaft and the output of the disconnect assembly, such as the output **316** of FIGS. **3-4B**.

[0159] Method **800** continues to **809**, flowing the fluid via at least the volume around the rotating element to the counter-pressure chamber. The volume is sandwiched between the rotating element and the outer rotating component of the clutch and disconnect assembly. **809** may include flowing fluid to the counter-pressure chamber via a third fluid passage, where the third fluid passage is a fluid passage is fluidically coupled to the volume and the counter-pressure chamber, and the third fluid passage extends through the outer rotating component. The third fluid passage may be the sixth passage **394** of FIGS. **3-4B**.

[0160] Method **800** continues to **810**, flowing the fluid into the volume of the counter-pressure chamber. Upon entering the counter-pressure chamber at least a portion of the fluid may flow outward toward the clutch pack. For example, a first portion of the fluid may flow to exit the counter-pressure chamber via a first means, while a second portion of the fluid may flow outward toward a volume housing a clutch pack and toward the piston.

[0161] Method **800** continues to **812**, flowing the fluid from the counter-pressure chamber to the clutch pack. Fluid may flow outward, such as radially outward, between the counter-pressure chamber and the clutch pack. **812** may comprise a plurality of substeps, including **814**, **815**. At least one of either **814** or **815** may be completed for **812**, and the other step of **814** or **815** is optional. However, method **800** may include carrying out both **814** and **815**.

[0162] **814** of **812** and method **800** includes flowing fluid through spaces and other volumes arranged between surfaces the piston and the clutch pack, such as through one or more cavities

between features, such as one or more lands, of the piston. Pressure from the counter-pressure chamber drives the fluid through the cavities and between the features. The cavities and lands allow contact between surfaces of the piston and the clutch pack, for compression of the clutch pack, while allowing the fluid to flow to the clutch pack. For example, **814** may include flowing the fluid through a fifth cavity **370** and the sixth cavity **371** of FIGS. 3-5 and between a first presser **542** and a second presser **544** of FIG. 5.

[0163] **815** of **812** and method **800** includes flowing fluid radially outward through a plurality of first fluid passages of the hub positioned around the counter-pressure chamber. The first fluid passages may be holes and, more specifically, bores extending outward through the hub from an axis the hub and counter pressure chamber are arranged radially round. The first fluid passages may extend radially outward through the hub. For example, **815** may include flowing the fluid through the eighth passages **389** of FIGS. 3-5.

[0164] Method **800** continues to **816**, cooling the clutch pack via force cooling using the fluid, and flowing the fluid through the clutch pack. Upon entering the clutch pack, fluid flows between and coats the plates of the clutch pack, such as friction plates and separator plates. The coating of the plates and the flowing of fluid therebetween lubricates the clutch pack preventing degradation from heat and mechanical forces, such as degradation from friction. Further the coating of the plates and the flowing of fluid therebetween cools the plates, where the fluid acts a heat exchange medium force removing thermal energy from and cooling the plates. The fluid may coat and flow around other surfaces and features of the clutch pack removing thermal energy from and cooling the clutch pack. Said in another way, the fluid may be heated and carry thermal energy away from the plates of the clutch pack.

[0165] Method **800** continues to **818**, flowing fluid from the clutch pack to one or more volumes around the drum of the clutch arranged around the clutch pack, removing thermal energy therefrom. **818** may include flowing fluid outward via a plurality of second fluid passages of the drum. The second fluid passages of the drum may be holes and, more specifically, bores. The fluid may be pushed out of the clutch pack through the second fluid passages via centripetal force and pressure. For example, **815** may include flowing the fluid through the seventh passages **387** of FIGS. 3-5.

[0166] Method **800** continues to **820**, flowing the heated fluid from the volumes around the drum into the rotating element of the disconnect assembly. For example, at **820** flows the heated fluid with the first portion of the fluid through a shaft and an output.

[0167] Method **800** continues to **822**, flowing the heated fluid with first portion of the fluid out of the disconnect assembly via lines fluidly coupled to lines in fluid communication with the rotating element. For example, at **822**, the fluid may be flowed out of the disconnect assembly via the ninth passage **396**.

[0168] After **822**, thermal energy built up via friction and other mechanical forces from the clutch is removed from the disconnect, and method **800** ends.

[0169] Therein the inventors have developed a method to cool the clutch via circulating a work fluid and lubricant, such as oil, from a counter-pressure chamber to a clutch pack via one or more features of the piston and via flowing lubricant through at least a first passage of a housing and a second passage of an input shaft to the counter-pressure chamber, where input shaft couples to or comprises an input to the clutch. Further the input to the clutch is or includes an outer rotating component of the clutch, such as a drum, that selectively couples to an output. Further, the output includes or is rigidly coupled to an inner rotating component, such as a hub. The housing is positioned around a clutch pack and an input shaft rigidly coupled to at least a component of the clutch pack, flowing lubricant through at least a second passage of the input shaft, flowing lubricant through at least a counter-pressure chamber, where the counter-pressure chamber is formed between the input shaft and an output shaft and between a piston and the output shaft of the clutch, flowing lubricant to at least a cavity of the piston from the counter-pressure chamber,

flowing lubricant from the cavity to the clutch pack, and coating a plurality of plates of the clutch pack with lubricant removing thermal energy therein. In a first example of the method, the method includes removing the lubricant from the clutch pack via the cavity and flowing fresh lubricant from the counter-pressure chamber, and removing thermal energy from the clutch via removal of lubricant and via convection between fresh lubricant delivered from the counter-pressure chamber mixing with lubricant flowing out from the clutch pack.

[0170] While various embodiments have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example, and not limitation. It will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant arts that the disclosed subject matter may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from the spirit of the subject matter. The embodiments described above are therefore to be considered in all respects as illustrative, not restrictive. As such, the configurations and routines disclosed herein are exemplary in nature, and that these specific examples are not to be considered in a limiting sense, because numerous variations are possible. For example, the above technology can be applied to powertrains that include different types of propulsion sources including different types of prime movers, internal combustion engines, and/or transmissions. The subject matter of the present disclosure includes all novel and non-obvious combinations and sub-combinations of the various systems and configurations, and other features, functions, and/or properties disclosed herein.

[0171] Note that the example control and estimation routines included herein can be used with various engine, electric machine, transmission, and/or vehicle system configurations. The control methods and routines disclosed herein may be stored as executable instructions in non-transitory memory and may be carried out by the control system including the controller in combination with the various sensors, actuators, and other engine hardware. The specific routines described herein may represent one or more of any number of processing strategies such as event-driven, interrupt-driven, multi-tasking, multi-threading, and the like. As such, various actions, operations, and/or functions illustrated may be performed in the sequence illustrated, in parallel, or in some cases omitted. Likewise, the order of processing is not necessarily required to achieve the features and advantages of the example embodiments described herein, but is provided for ease of illustration and description. One or more of the illustrated actions, operations, and/or functions may be repeatedly performed depending on the particular strategy being used. Further, the described actions, operations, and/or functions may graphically represent code to be programmed into non-transitory memory of the computer readable storage medium in the engine control system, where the described actions are carried out by executing the instructions in a system including the various engine hardware components in combination with the electronic controller.

[0172] Note that the example control and estimation routines included herein can be used with various engine, electric machine, transmission, and/or vehicle system configurations. The control methods and routines disclosed herein may be stored as executable instructions in non-transitory memory and may be carried out by the control system including the controller in combination with the various sensors, actuators, and other engine hardware. The specific routines described herein may represent one or more of any number of processing strategies such as event-driven, interrupt-driven, multi-tasking, multi-threading, and the like. As such, various actions, operations, and/or functions illustrated may be performed in the sequence illustrated, in parallel, or in some cases omitted. Likewise, the order of processing is not necessarily required to achieve the features and advantages of the example embodiments described herein, but is provided for ease of illustration and description. One or more of the illustrated actions, operations, and/or functions may be repeatedly performed depending on the particular strategy being used. Further, the described actions, operations, and/or functions may graphically represent code to be programmed into non-transitory memory of the computer readable storage medium in the engine control system, where the described actions are carried out by executing the instructions in a system including the various engine hardware components in combination with the electronic controller.

[0173] It will be appreciated that the configurations and routines disclosed herein are exemplary in nature, and that these specific embodiments are not to be considered in a limiting sense, because numerous variations are possible. Moreover, unless explicitly stated to the contrary, the terms “first,” “second,” “third,” and the like are not intended to denote any order, position, quantity, or importance, but rather are used merely as labels to distinguish one element from another. The subject matter of the present disclosure includes all novel and non-obvious combinations and sub-combinations of the various systems and configurations, and other features, functions, and/or properties disclosed herein.

[0174] The following claims particularly point out certain combinations and sub-combinations regarded as novel and non-obvious. These claims may refer to “an” element or “a first” element or the equivalent thereof. Such claims should be understood to include incorporation of one or more such elements, neither requiring nor excluding two or more such elements. Other combinations and sub-combinations of the disclosed features, functions, elements, and/or properties may be claimed through amendment of the present claims or through presentation of new claims in this or a related application. Such claims, whether broader, narrower, equal, or different in scope to the original claims, also are regarded as included within the subject matter of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A disconnect for a power take off (PTO), the disconnect comprising: a housing, where the housing includes a plurality of fluid channels; a wet clutch, where the wet clutch comprises a clutch pack; a piston; an input, where the input is connected to an outer rotating component of the wet clutch; and an output, where the output is connected to an inner rotating component of the wet clutch; where the input selectively couples to the output closing the clutch pack, wherein the clutch pack is hydraulically closed by way of a fluid acting on the piston and the piston pressing on the clutch pack, where the fluid channels are in fluid communication with the piston and deliver hydraulic pressure thereto.
2. The disconnect of claim 1, where the piston is configured to rotate with a shaft and fluidly seal the shaft to the housing, where one or more rings of the piston seal the shaft to the housing.
3. The disconnect of claim 2, where the shaft is the input.
4. The disconnect of claim 1, wherein the wet clutch comprises an actuation chamber formed between the outer rotating component and the piston, and a counter-pressure chamber formed between the inner rotating component and the piston, the actuation chamber fluidly coupled to a first flow path and the counter-pressure chamber fluidly coupled to a second flow path.
5. The disconnect of claim 4, wherein the second flow path is configured to force cool the wet clutch.
6. The disconnect of claim 5, wherein the second flow path is configured to force cool the clutch pack.
7. The disconnect of claim 4, wherein the piston presses upon the clutch pack in response to increasing fluid pressure in the actuation chamber.
8. The disconnect of claim 4, wherein the piston has a plurality of steps, with at least a first step of a first diameter and a second step of a second diameter, where the first diameter is less than the second diameter, and the first step is in fluid communication with the actuation chamber.
9. The disconnect of claim 8, where the piston is a threshold of distance from the outer rotating component and the second step is in fluid communication with the actuation chamber.
10. The disconnect of claim 4, wherein the counter-pressure chamber includes a spring applying a resistive force opposite to a direction of engagement of the piston.
11. The disconnect of claim 10, wherein the spring returns piston to a position in response to decreasing fluid pressure in the actuation chamber.
12. The disconnect of claim 1, wherein the clutch pack comprises a plurality of friction plates and a

plurality of separator plates, wherein the piston pressing the plurality of friction plates into surface sharing contact with the plurality of separator plates compresses the clutch pack, and wherein reduction of force from the piston expands the plurality of friction plates from surface contact with the plurality of separator plates.

13. The disconnect of claim 1, where the wet clutch is normally closed during PTO operation of the disconnect.

14. The disconnect of claim 1, where the wet clutch is normally open during PTO operation of the disconnect.

15. The disconnect of claim 1, further comprising an integrated valve that fluidly couples to the disconnect.

16. A method of cooling a clutch for a disconnect of a PTO, comprising: flowing lubricant through at least a first passage of a housing, where the housing is positioned around a clutch pack and an input shaft rigidly coupled to at least a component of the clutch pack; flowing lubricant through at least a second passage of the input shaft; flowing lubricant through at least a counter-pressure chamber, where the counter-pressure chamber is formed between the input shaft and an output shaft and between a piston and the output shaft of the clutch; flowing lubricant to at least a space between the clutch pack and the counter-pressure chamber; flowing lubricant from the space to the clutch pack; and coating a plurality of plates of the clutch pack with lubricant removing thermal energy therein.

17. The method of cooling the clutch of claim 16, comprising, removing the lubricant from the clutch pack via a plurality of fluid passages extending through a drum around the clutch pack and therein removing thermal energy from the clutch pack.

18. The method of cooling the clutch of claim 16, comprising, flowing lubricant to the clutch pack from the counter-pressure chamber via a plurality of passages through a plurality of fluid passages extending through a hub, where the clutch pack is around the hub and the space is a fluid passage of the fluid passages.

19. The method of cooling the clutch of claim 17, flowing lubricant through at least a cavity of the piston, where the cavity is the space, and the cavity enables flow between the piston and the clutch during closing of the clutch.

20. A disconnect for a power take off (PTO), the disconnect comprising: an input connected to an inner rotating component of a wet clutch and an output connected to an outer rotating component of the wet clutch, the input selectively coupling to the output by compressing a clutch pack, wherein the clutch pack is compressed by way of a fluid acting on a piston and reacting on a shaft, where the fluid is delivered via an external flow.
